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How to Rank Your Website on Page #1 of Google



Topics Covered

1 SEO 101

2 Keyword Research

3 On-Page SEO

4 Off-Page SEO

5 SEO Analytics



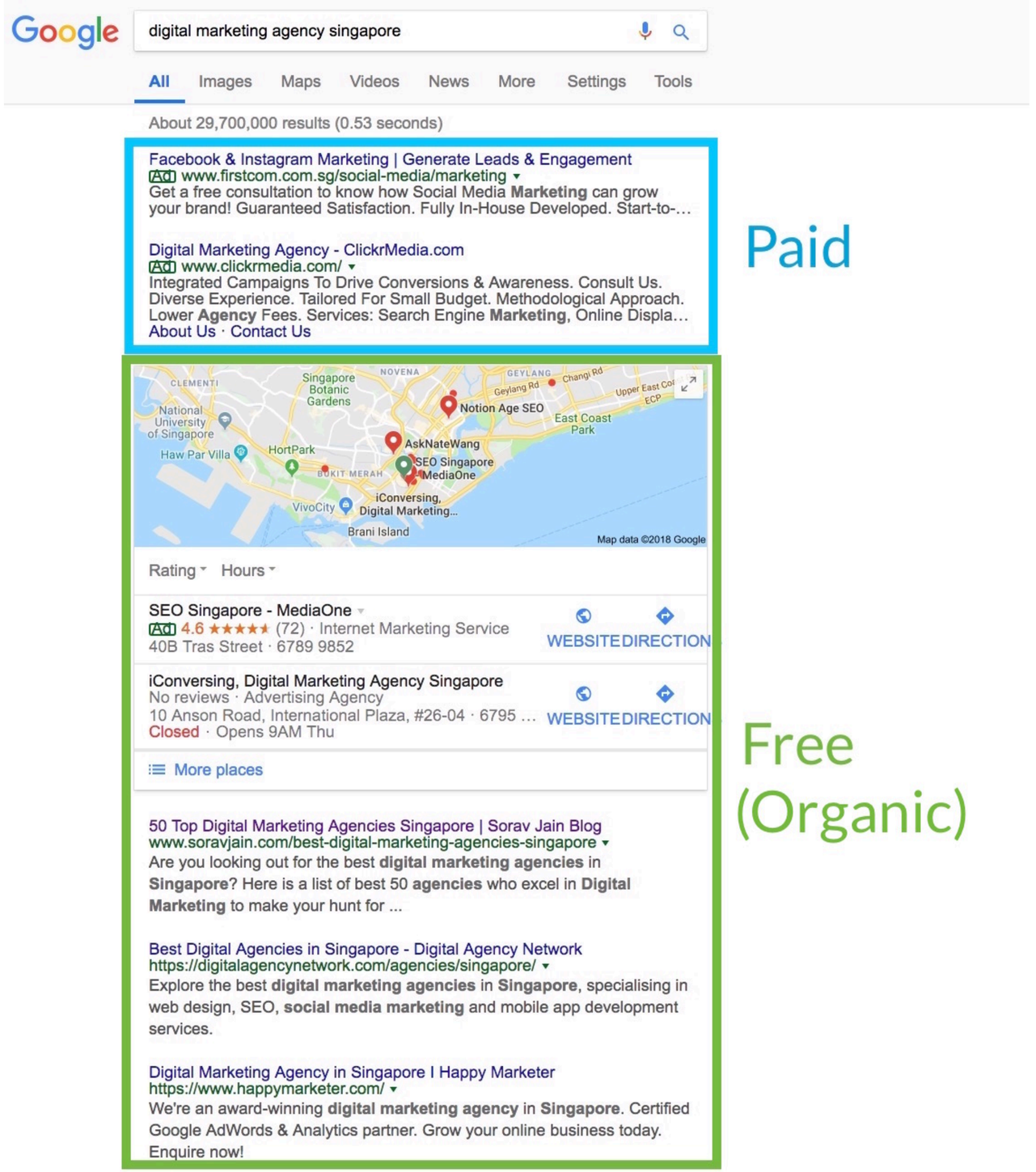
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What is SEO?

Search Engine Optimisation or SEO is the practice of increasing a website's visibility on the organic search engine results pages.



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How Do Search Engines Work?

Crawling

Search engine spiders crawl the web through following links

Indexing

Search engines store the information it collects into its index.

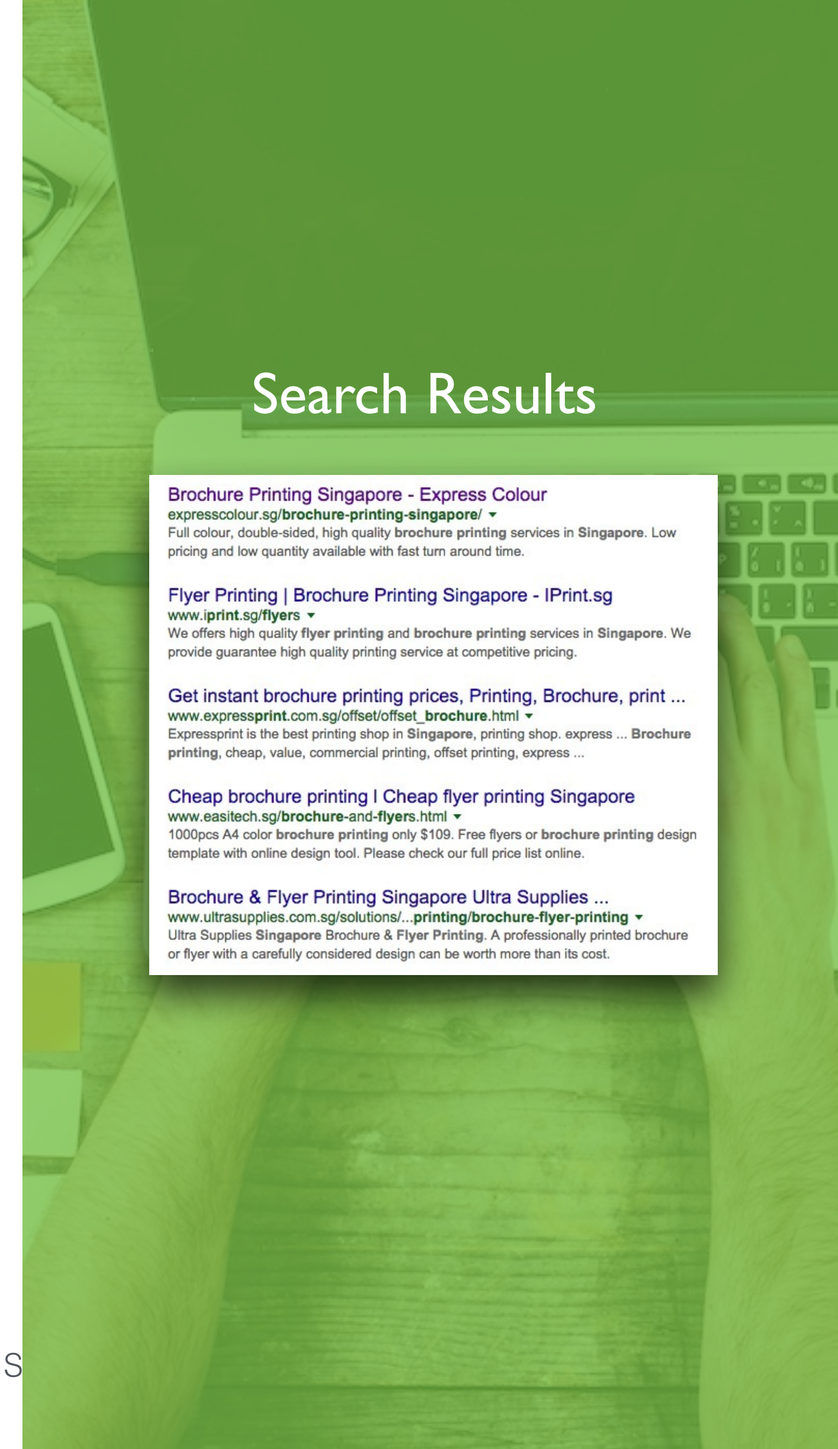
Ranking

A score is given to each of webpage after taking into account hundreds of **ranking factors.**

Algorithms

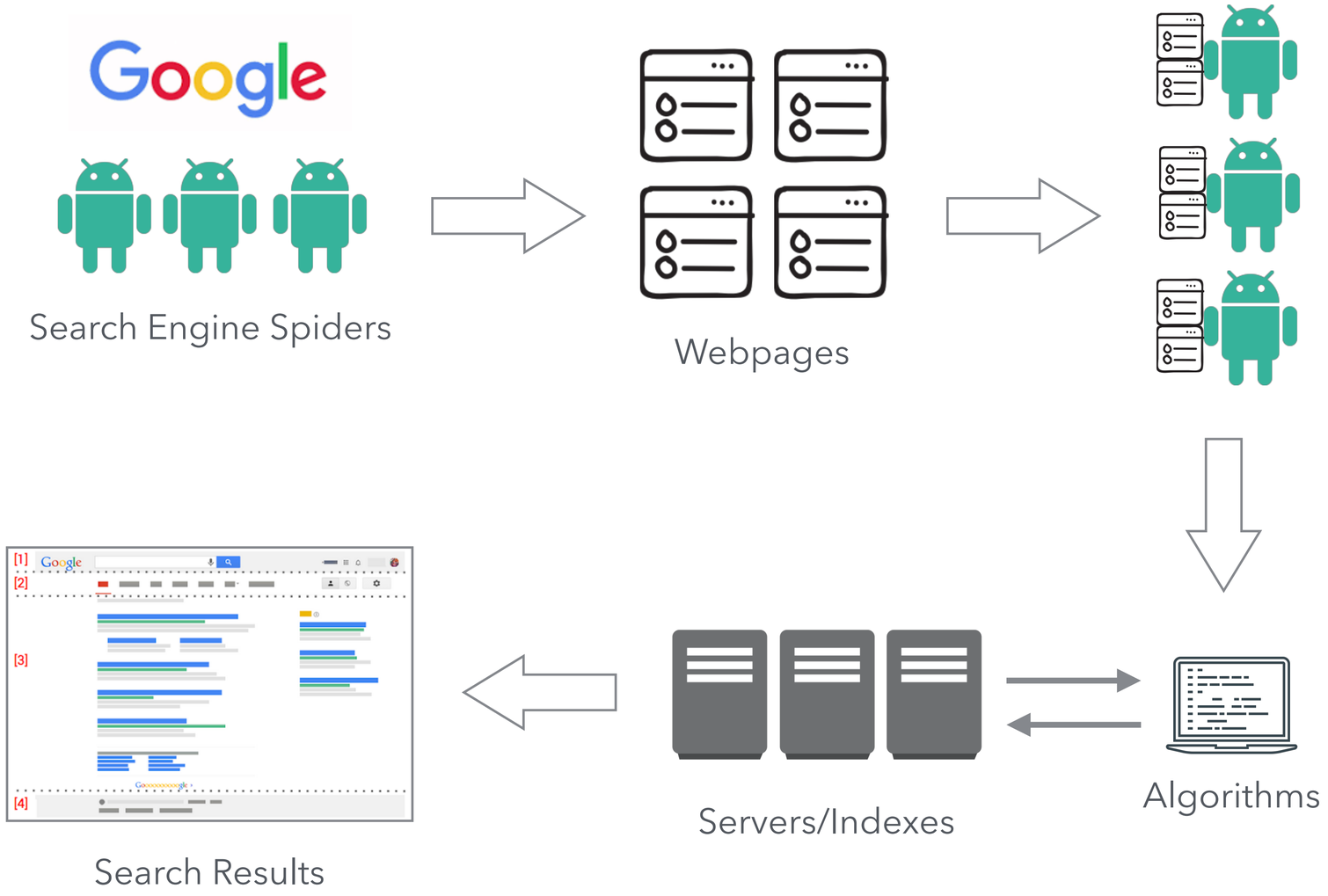
To calculate authority and relevancy of a webpage to a given search query.

Search Results



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How Do Search Engines Work?



White Hat Vs Black Hat SEO

Google's search engine algorithms are constantly evolving to combat black hat techniques, and take a very serious note on black hat link building.

Some black hat SEO techniques include:

- Keyword stuffing
- Duplicating internal pages on a mass scale
- Sneaky redirects
- Displaying different results to users and search engines.
- Over-optimised keyword-rich anchor text on inbound links, especially on low quality sites

Keyword Stuffing Example:
This cake decorating tutorial will show you a cake decorating tutorial on how to decorate a cake. The first part of this cake decorating tutorial is on how to decorate a cake. Here's how to decorate a cake in this cake decorating tutorial.



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Google Major Algorithm Changes

Google changes its search algorithm around 500 - 600 times each year. That's 1 - 2 times on average each day. Some algorithm updates have tremendous results on the search rankings. Below is a list of major algorithmic updates in recent years:

- Panda
- Penguin
- Hummingbird
- Mobile Update
- RankBrain
- Unnamed Updates

Recommended reading:
- https://moz.com/google-algorithm-change
- http://searchengineland.com/library/google/google-algorithm-updates



Panda Update (2011)

Lower the rankings of low-quality sites.



Penguin Update (2012)

Decrease rankings of sites that engage in shady link building.



Hummingbird Update (2013)

Relevancy and Knowledge graph update (Semantic Search).



Mobile-Friendly Update (2015)

Impacts mobile search rankings of non-mobile-friendly pages.



RankBrain (2015)

A machine learning algorithm that aims to present the most potentially correct document in response to unfamiliar or verbose queries.



Unnamed Updates (2018)

Rankings showed a spike in volatility around February 20th, 2018 which quickly settled down, sometimes signalling a targeted algorithm update.

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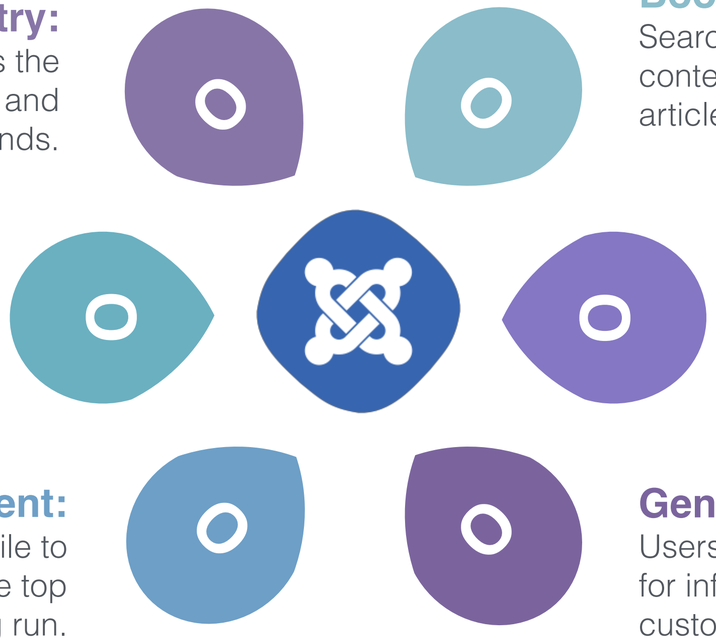
Search Engine Optimisation

Key Features and Advantages

Positions your brand as the authority in your industry:
Ranking prominently for multiple search terms across the consumer buying journey establishes brand authority and puts your brand in the forefront of consumers' minds.

Drives brand awareness and visibility:
Websites ranking on the first page of the search results enjoy great visibility and brand awareness.

Long-term return on investment:
Search engine optimisation activities may take awhile to produce returns. However, the results (i.e. ranking on the top of Google) bring continual return on investment in the long run.



Boosts your content marketing efforts:
Search engine optimisation campaigns complement your content marketing efforts by optimising content (e.g. blogposts, articles, listicles) to rank better on search engines.

Higher traffic share compared to the paid search results:
In some categories, the click through rate of the first webpage on the organic search results can be as high as 94.95%.

Generates highly relevant and high quality traffic:
Users who search and click through your site are actively looking for information and more likely to engage and convert into customers.

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Positions your brand as the authority in your industry

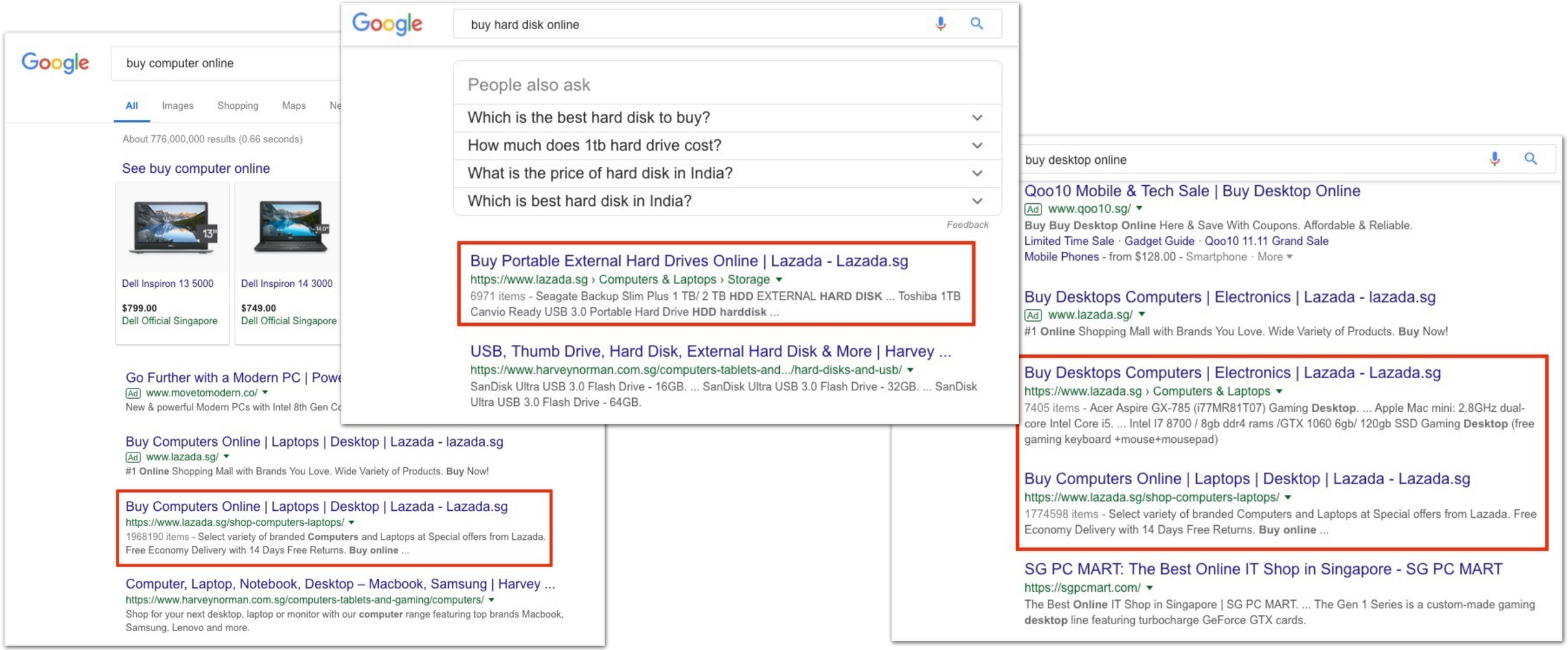
Drives brand awareness and visibility

Generates highly relevant and high quality traffic

Higher traffic share compared to the paid search results

Long-term return on investment

Boosts your content marketing efforts



Search Engine Optimisation

Constraints



Can get very competitive:

Since organic search traffic costs nothing, competition can get very steep and achieving top rankings can take a long time and get very costly.

Delayed Results:

Rank jumps typically take an average of 10 weeks to 6 months, but it can also take a few years to rank on the top of Google for highly competitive keywords.





Requires technical expertise:

Organisations may not have the required technical expertise in-house and have to hire SEOs or outsource technical SEO implementation to a third party.

Can be very costly to implement and maintain:

Depending on how large the website is, technical expertise can cost quite a bit in order to optimise the website on a large scale. The more competitive an industry is, the larger the scale of content marketing and online PR activities are required and the higher the costs involved to continuously run these campaigns.





Dependent on a content marketing strategy for long term maintenance:

One of the main ranking factors is the off-page link acquisition rate, which depends on how well a content marketing strategy is executed.

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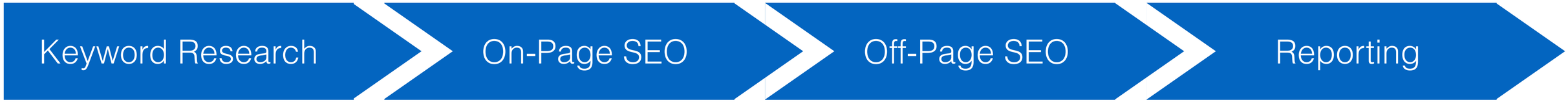
SEO VS SEM

	SEO	SEM
Pros	• Boosts brand awareness • Users from search channel have high conversion rates	
	• Long-term returns • Higher traffic share than SEM	• Efficient results • Precise targeting options • Better tracking of search terms that direct users to your website than SEO
Cons	• Requires technical expertise • Costly to maintain	
	• Delayed results • Difficult to track all search terms that direct users to your website compared to SEM	• Results decay quickly once ad budget runs out

Source: https://www.equinetacademy.com/seo-vs-sem/

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The 4-Step SEO Process



Step 1: Conduct keyword research

The first step of any SEO campaign is to conduct keyword research. Doing SEO without knowing what keywords your site should rank for is like firing at a target without first taking aim.

Detailed keyword research and analysis sets your SEO campaign up for success in the long run.

Step 2: Make your site search engine friendly

Once you have gathered a targeted list of keywords, the next step would be to input those keywords into your existing content. You can also use your keyword list to give you new content ideas.

Other on-page SEO factors include site speed, mobile optimisation, site architecture, and internal linking.

Step 3: Link building and local citation building

After taking care of your on-page SEO, here comes the hard part.

Off-page SEO activities include link building and building local citations.

Step 4: Reporting and analysis

Your SEO campaign doesn't stop here. Check your keyword ranking reports, regularly monitor your site health through 3rd party tools such as Google Webmaster Tools, check your backlink reports, and identify potential areas for improvement.

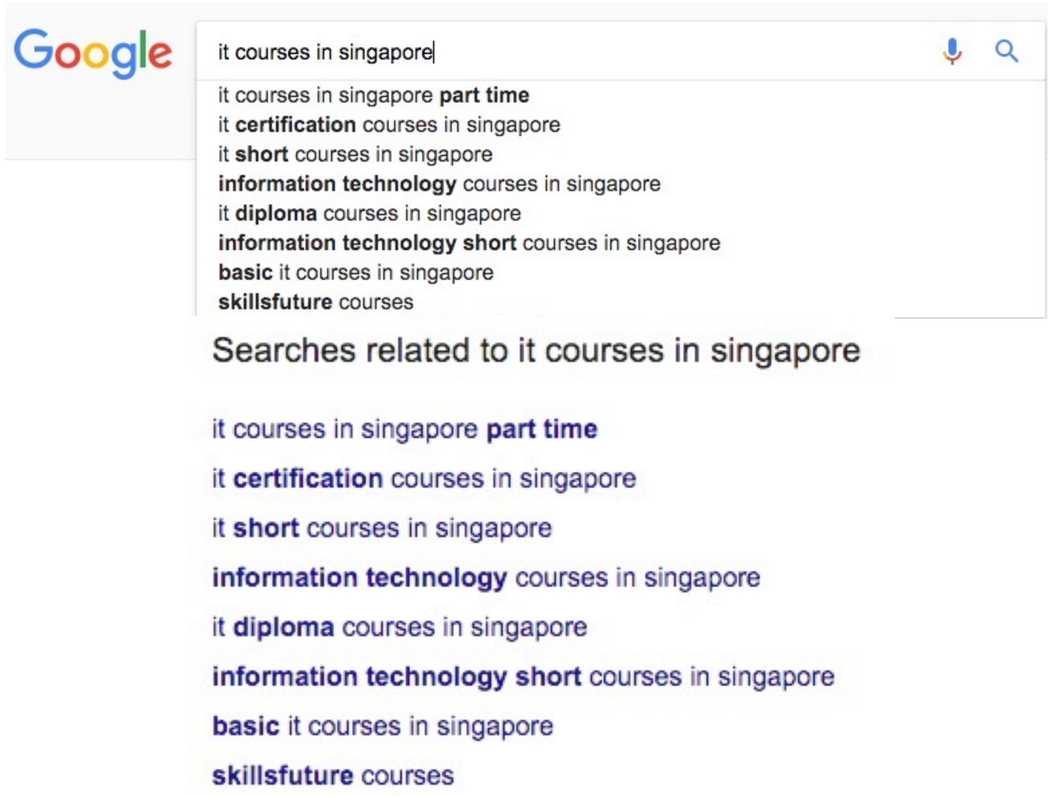
2

Keyword Research

How to conduct keyword research like a pro

What is Keyword Research?

Keyword research is finding out what search terms your potential customers are using, so that you can optimise your site better with the data.



4 Principles of Effective Keyword Research

1 Grasp Your Site Architecture

Grasping your site architecture allows you to segment similar-themed keywords into silos (different pages). For an e-commerce site, generic keywords like “wooden tables” and “tables made of wood” can be grouped into a category landing page while more specific keywords like “wooden coffee table” and “coffee table made of wood” can be grouped into a single product page.

2 Know Who Your Customers Are

Knowing what keywords your potential customers are using can help you better optimise your content for them and for the search engines (e.g. by including the keywords in your title tags, URL, meta description, copy, and image alt tags.)

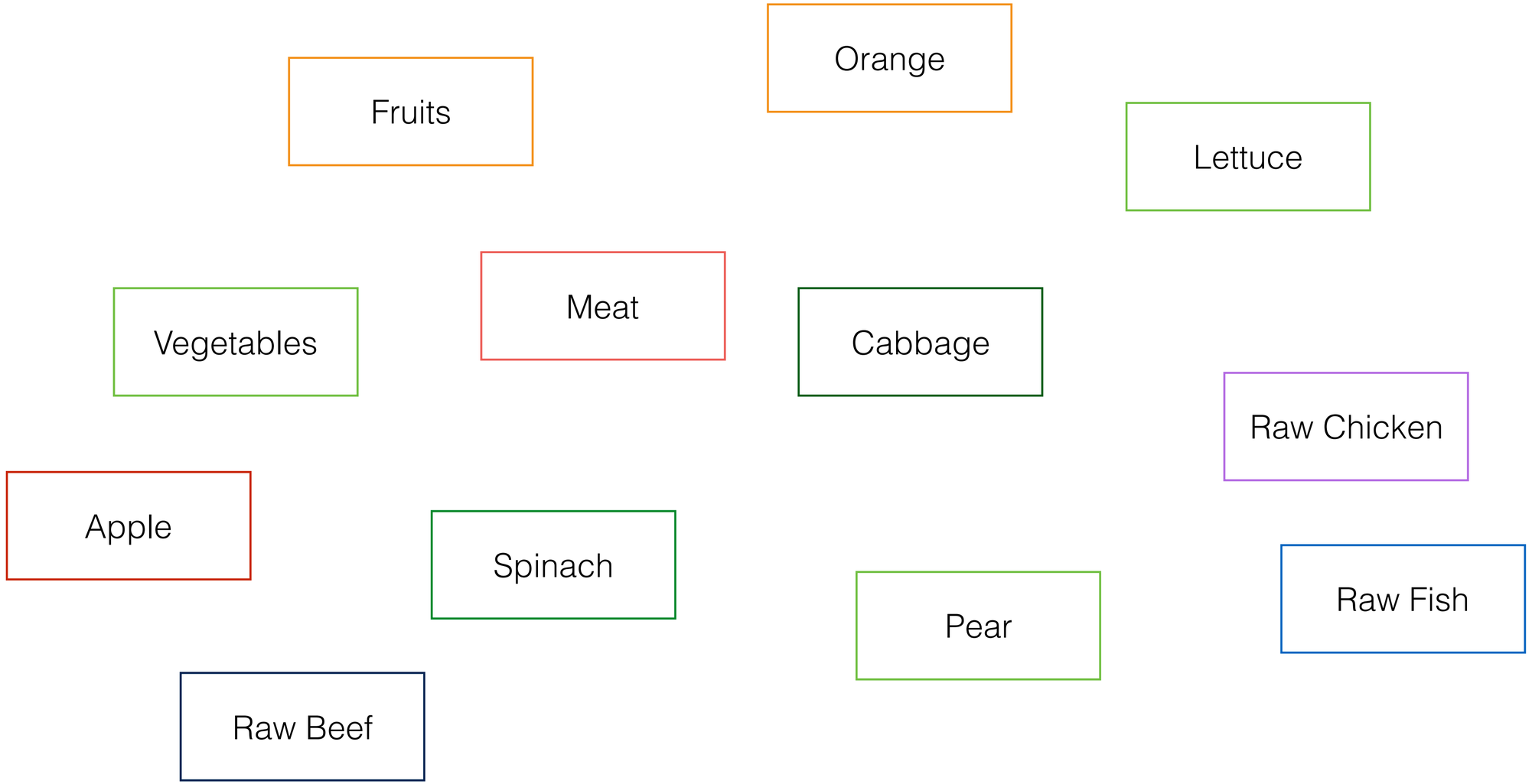
3 Recognise the Customer Buying Journey

Recognising and plotting out your customer buying journey can help you identify more search queries your customers use to assist themselves in their buying journey. This helps you branch out to more keyword themes and create content for each.

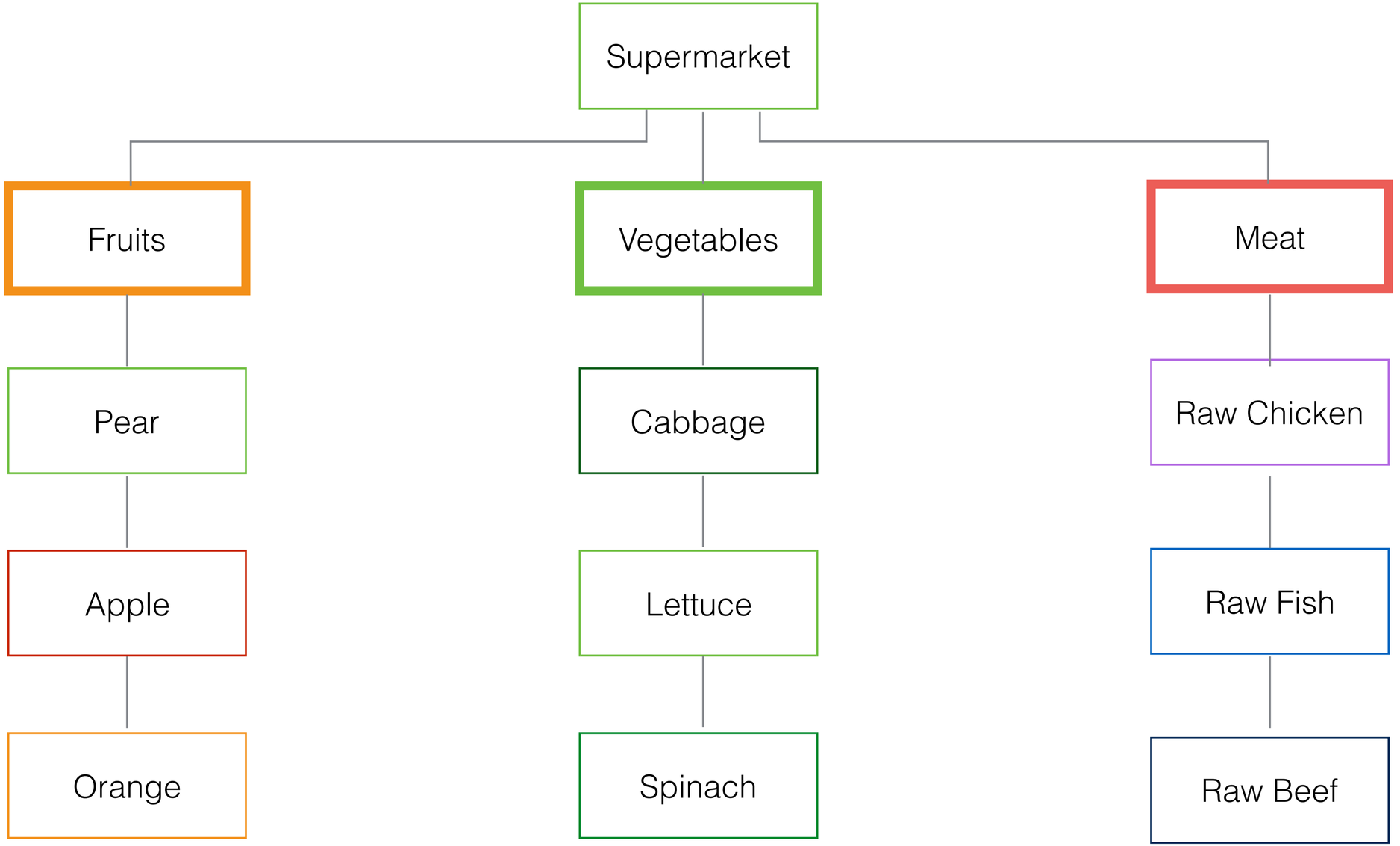
4 Understand the Customer Search Intent

Understanding the customer search intent helps you decide what content type and content format to develop in order to best answer the search query. It also helps you to group intent-relevant keyword themes into a single page.

1. Grasp Your Site Architecture

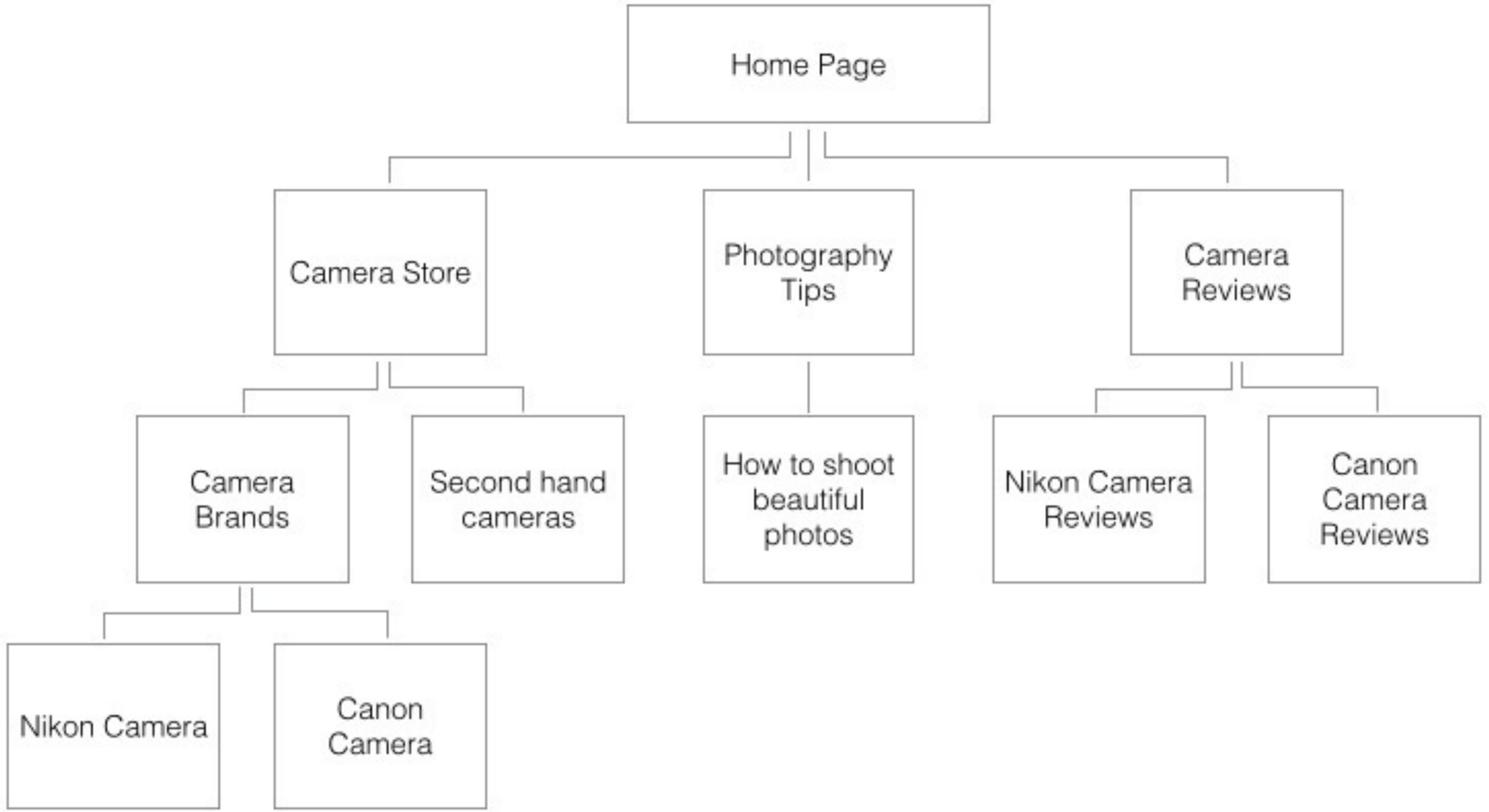


1. Grasp Your Site Architecture



1. Grasp Your Site Architecture

Flat Site Architecture



2. Know Who Your Customers Are

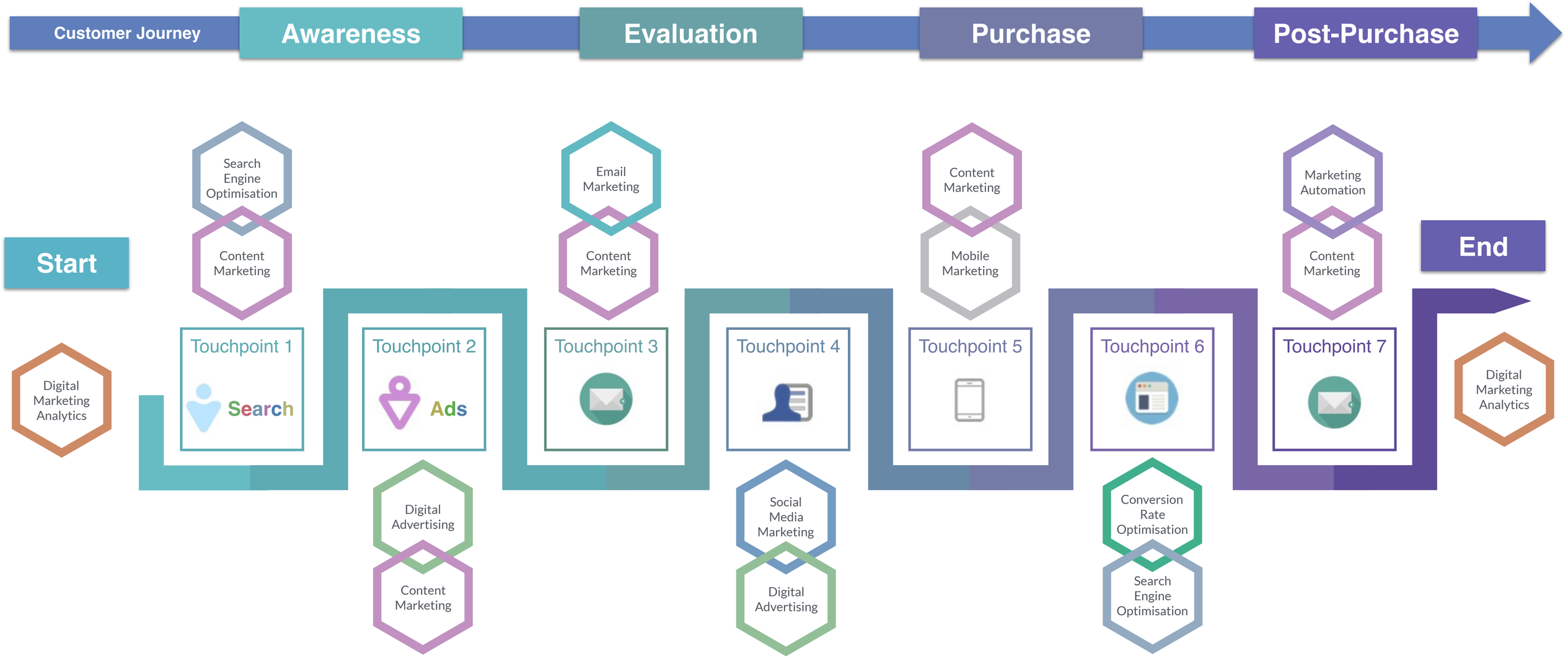


Your customers use keywords/ search terms to search for your business.



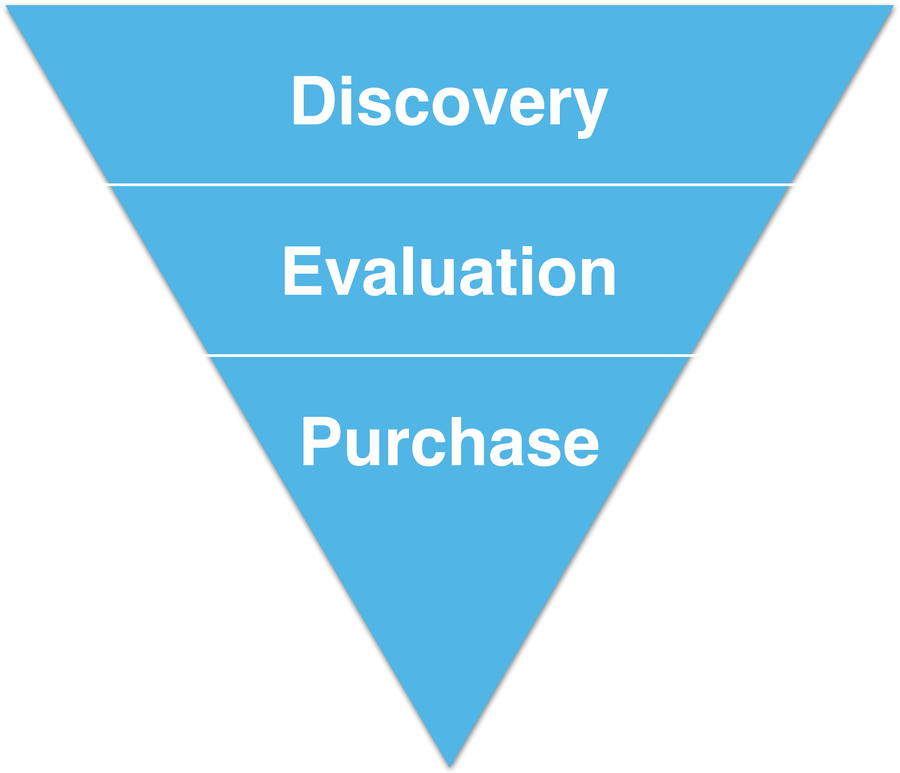
Your job is to know who these customers are and what keywords they use in search.

3. Recognise the Customer Buying Journey



3. Recognise the Customer Buying Journey

Buying Funnel



Top of the funnel

Bottom of the funnel

Some examples of keywords in various buying stages:

"Discovery" keywords:

- *list of photoshop software*
- *what IT courses should I take*

"Discovery" keywords:

- *how to edit a picture in photoshop*
- *photoshop tutorial*

Informational Content

"Evaluation" keywords:

- *novasoft photoshop course review*
- *best photoshop courses in sg*

"Purchase" keywords:

- *novasoft photoshop course signup*
- *novasoft photoshop course*

Product-Centered Content

4. Understand the Customer Search Intent

Keywords

Short-tail

Long-tail

Location-based

Brand-related



Stage of Customer Journey

Discovery

Evaluation

Purchase



Content Type & Format

Informative Blogpost

How-to Video

Step-by-step Tutorial

Tool/App

Product/Service Details

4. Understand the Customer Search Intent (Example 1)

Keywords	Stage of Customer Journey	Content Type & Format
Photoshop tutorial Step by step photoshop guide learn photoshop	Discovery	How-to Video + Step-by-step tutorial in blogpost format E.g. Title: Step by Step Photoshop Tutorial For Beginners





4. Understand the Customer Search Intent (Example 2)

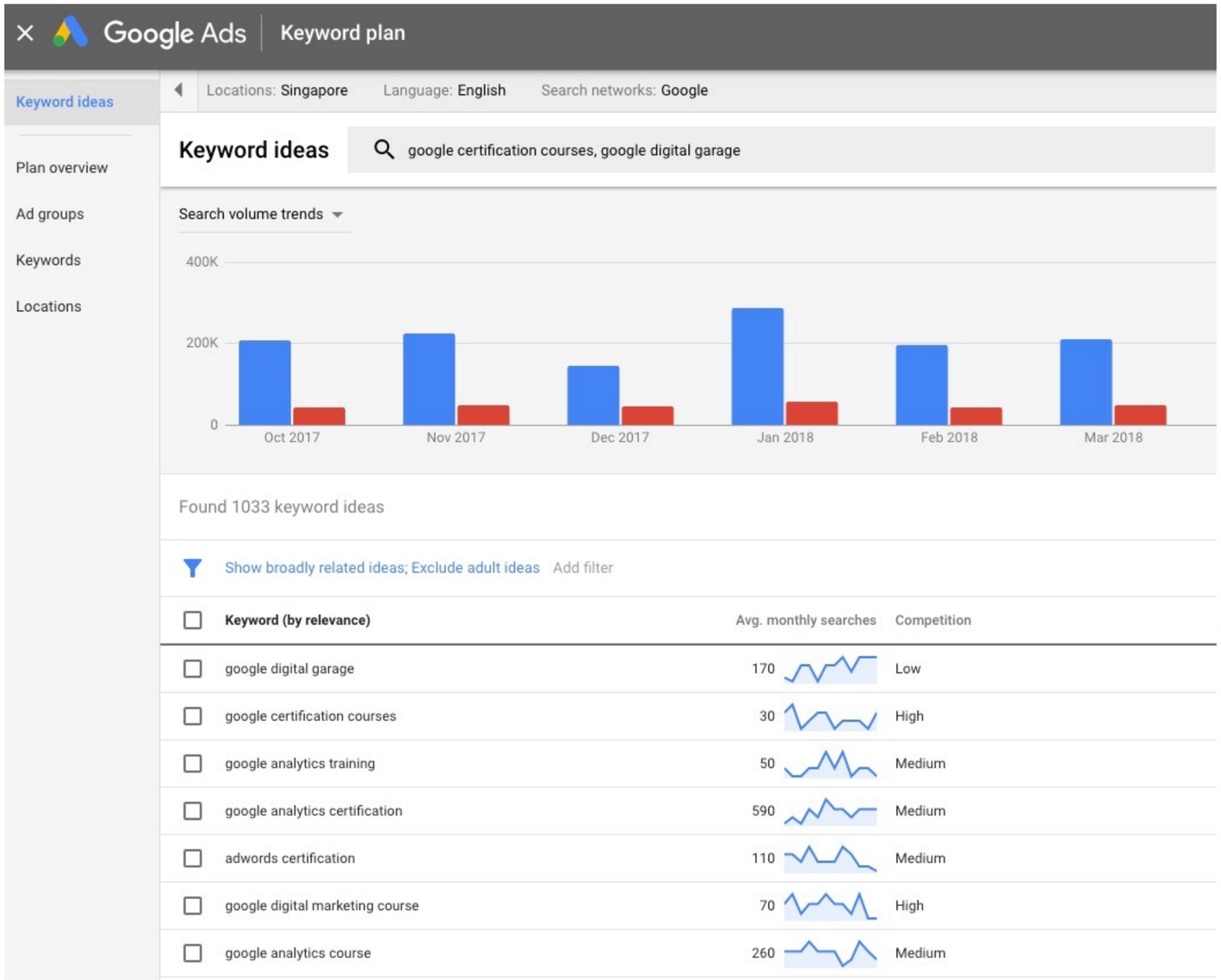
Keywords	Stage of Customer Journey	Content Type & Format
photoshop course singapore photoshop workshop novasoft photoshop course	Purchase	Product details/ course landing page E.g. Title: 2-Day Photoshop Course in Singapore

Conducting Keyword Research

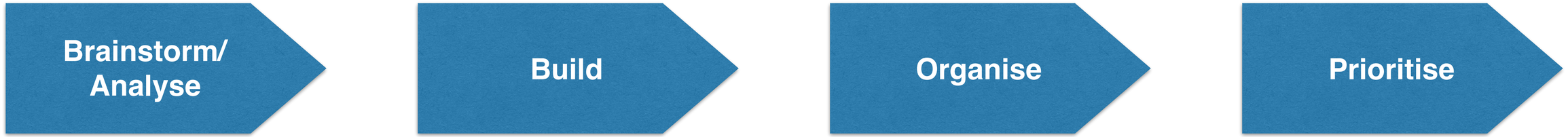
Recommended keyword research tools

Here are some free and premium keyword research tools to consider using:

- Google Keyword Planner
- Ubersuggest
- keywordtool.io
- semrush
- Answerthepublic
- Ahrefs Keyword Explorer



Implementing a 4-Step Keyword Research Process



Brainstorm/Analyse:
- Who your customers are
- Your customer journey
- Customer intent
- Site architecture

Build:
Build on and expand the keywords you are targeting using one or more keyword research tools

Organise:
Group your keywords into similar-theme/ concept pages

Prioritise by:
- Search volume
- Competitiveness
- Keyword ROI

3

On-Page SEO

How to fix internal site issues and optimise your pages to boost rankings.

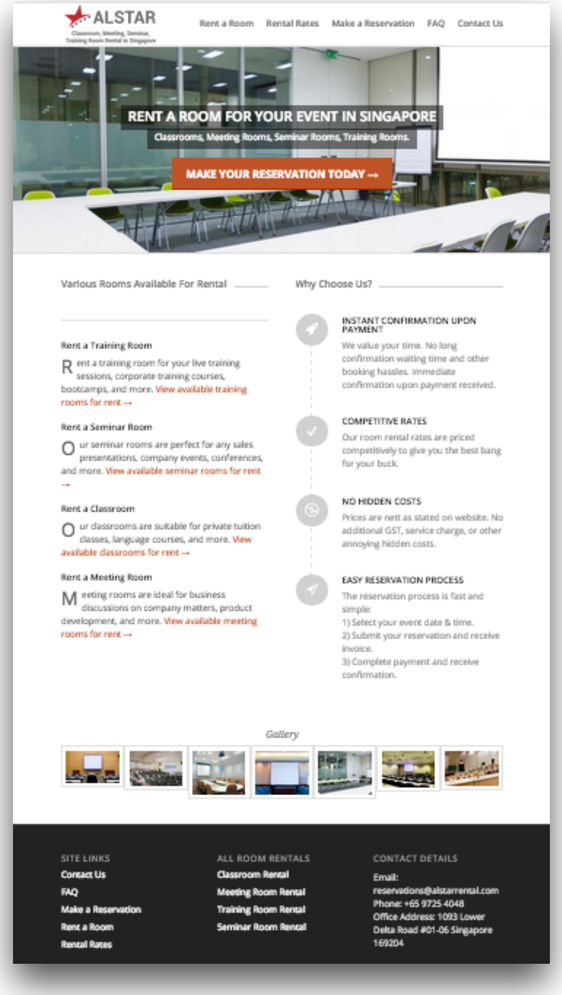
What is On-Page SEO / Why is it Important?

1. Search engines look for cues (i.e. keywords in the title and URL) on a webpage to determine whether it is relevant enough to rank for a set of search terms.

2. There are also other factors that search engines take into account such as site load time, page crawlability, and click-thru-rate.

3. On-Page SEO is understanding these ranking factors and fixing any issues to make your site more friendly to the search engines.

4. Without fixing your on-page SEO issues, it can be difficult to rank well even with good off-page SEO.



On-Page SEO Cheat Sheet

1) Keywords in URL

Url: www.webdesign.com/**ecommerce-web-design**/

<head><meta name="description" content="We provide the best and most affordable commerce web design packages in the market.">

2) Keywords in Meta Description

<title>E-commerce Web Design Service</title></head>

<h1>E-commerce Web Design Service</h1>

3) Keywords in Title Tags

5) LSI Keywords in Content Area

We provide the best custom **e-commerce web design services**

6) Quality & Uniqueness of Content

4) Keywords in Subheadings

<h2>Why We Provide The Best **Website Design Package**</h2>

Image
Keyword inserted into Title and/or Alt Text

8) Link out to relevant sources if possible

Designing a site requires…

Website creation process…

9) Interlink articles with relevant anchor text (Site architecture)

View our other web design packages ->

7) Keywords in Image Title & Alt Tags

Title Tag (Best Practices)

- [ ] Ensure it is wrapped around the title tags <title>Example title</title>
- [ ] Place the keyword closer to the front of the title.
- [ ] Ensure your title is unique, outstanding, and appealing.
- [ ] Keep the length of your title between 50 - 60 characters.
- [ ] Include your brand name in the title tag - In front for the homepage and at the back for other pages of your site.
- [ ] Optimise for multiple keywords

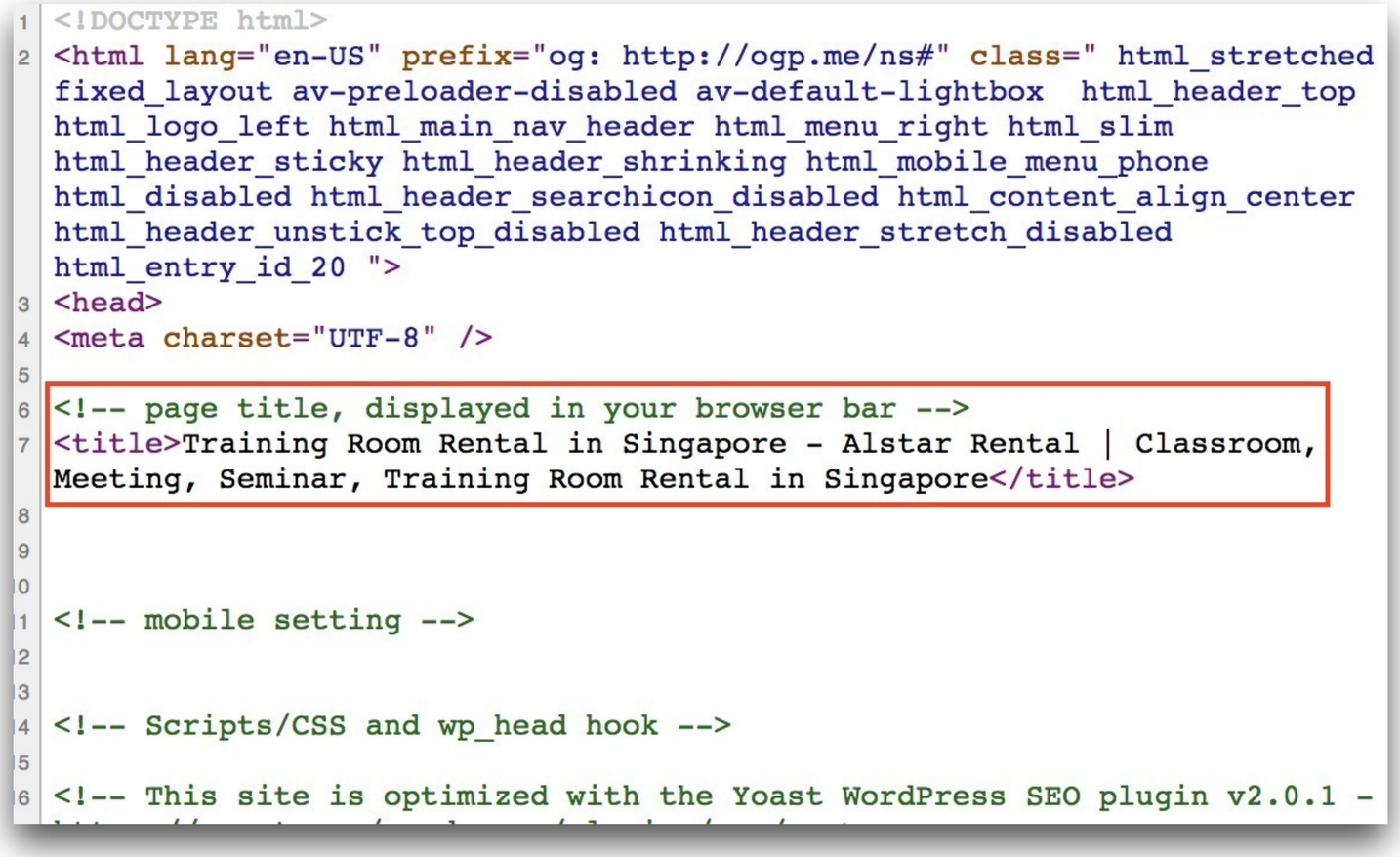
Recommended reading:
- https://moz.com/learn/seo/title-tag
- https://searchenginewatch.com/sew/how-to/2154469/write-title-tags-search-engine-optimization

Title Tag (Best Practices)

Ensure it is wrapped around the title tags <title>Example title</title>

To check whether your title is wrapped around the title <title> tags:

1. Open the webpage on your Chrome browser
2. Right click and select “view source”
3. Enter “Ctrl + F (Windows) / Cmd + F (Mac)” on your keyboard and search for “title”



```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html lang="en-US" prefix="og: http://ogp.me/ns#" class=" html_stretched
fixed_layout av-preloader-disabled av-default-lightbox  html_header_top
html_logo_left html_main_nav_header html_menu_right html_slim
html_header_sticky html_header_shrinking html_mobile_menu_phone
html_disabled html_header_searchicon_disabled html_content_align_center
html_header_unstick_top_disabled html_header_stretch_disabled
html_entry_id_20 ">
<head>
<meta charset="UTF-8" />

<!-- page title, displayed in your browser bar -->
<title>Training Room Rental in Singapore - Alstar Rental | Classroom,
Meeting, Seminar, Training Room Rental in Singapore</title>



<!-- mobile setting -->


<!-- Scripts/CSS and wp_head hook -->

<!-- This site is optimized with the Yoast WordPress SEO plugin v2.0.1 -
```

Title Tag (Best Practices)

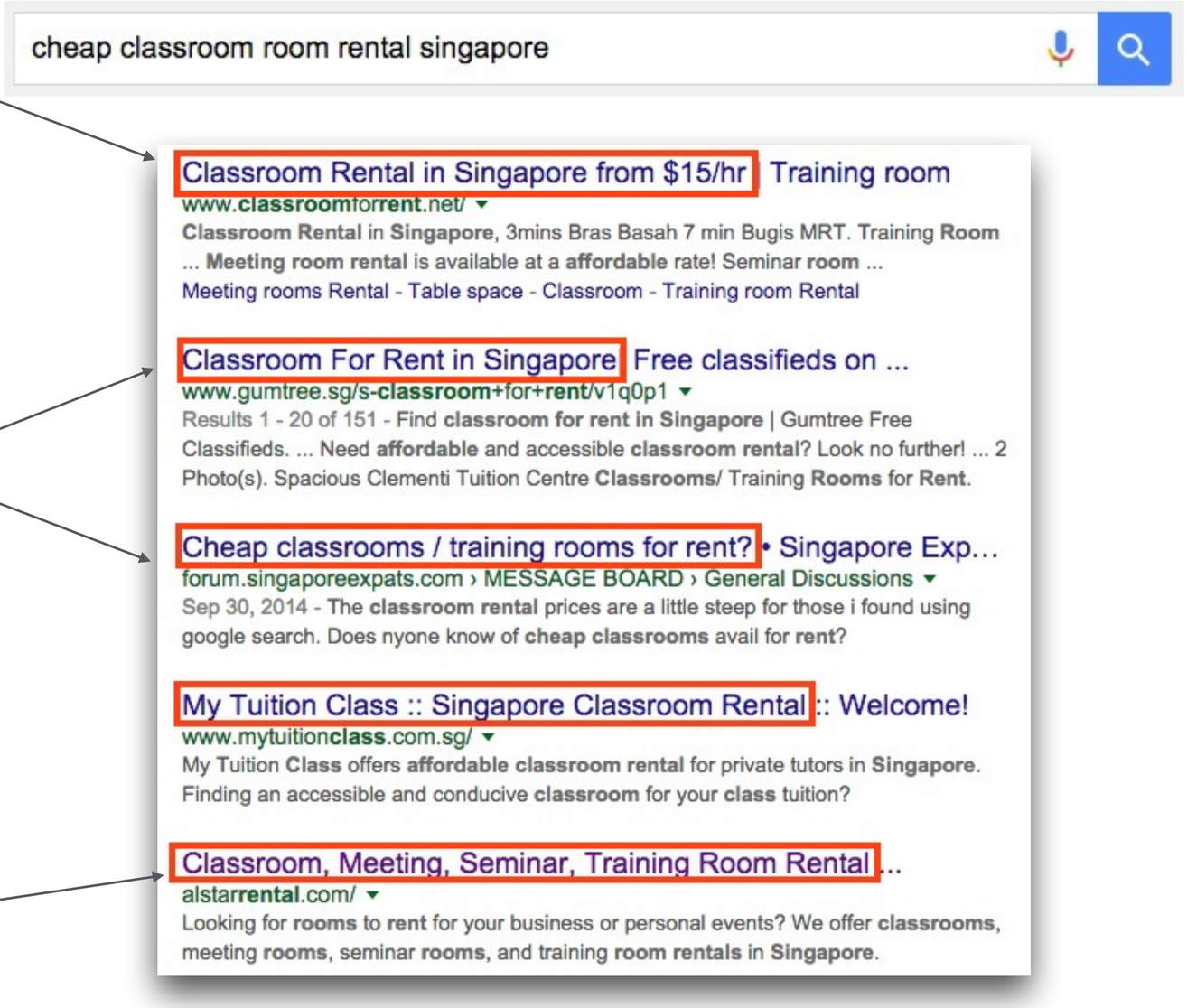
Place the keyword as closer to the front of the title.

Moz tested and concluded that this increases the likelihood of a user clicking on the search result and also helps in search engine rankings.

Ensure your title is unique, outstanding, and appealing. Cross check with competitor sites and your own internal page titles. Consider the searcher intent and make your title appeal to their emotions. The more appealing the title, the higher the click-through-rate. Search engines also place importance in the uniqueness of your title.

Keep the length of your title between 50 - 60 characters / 512 pixels wide.

If the title is too long, search engines will truncate the titles and show an ellipsis.



Title Tag (Best Practices)

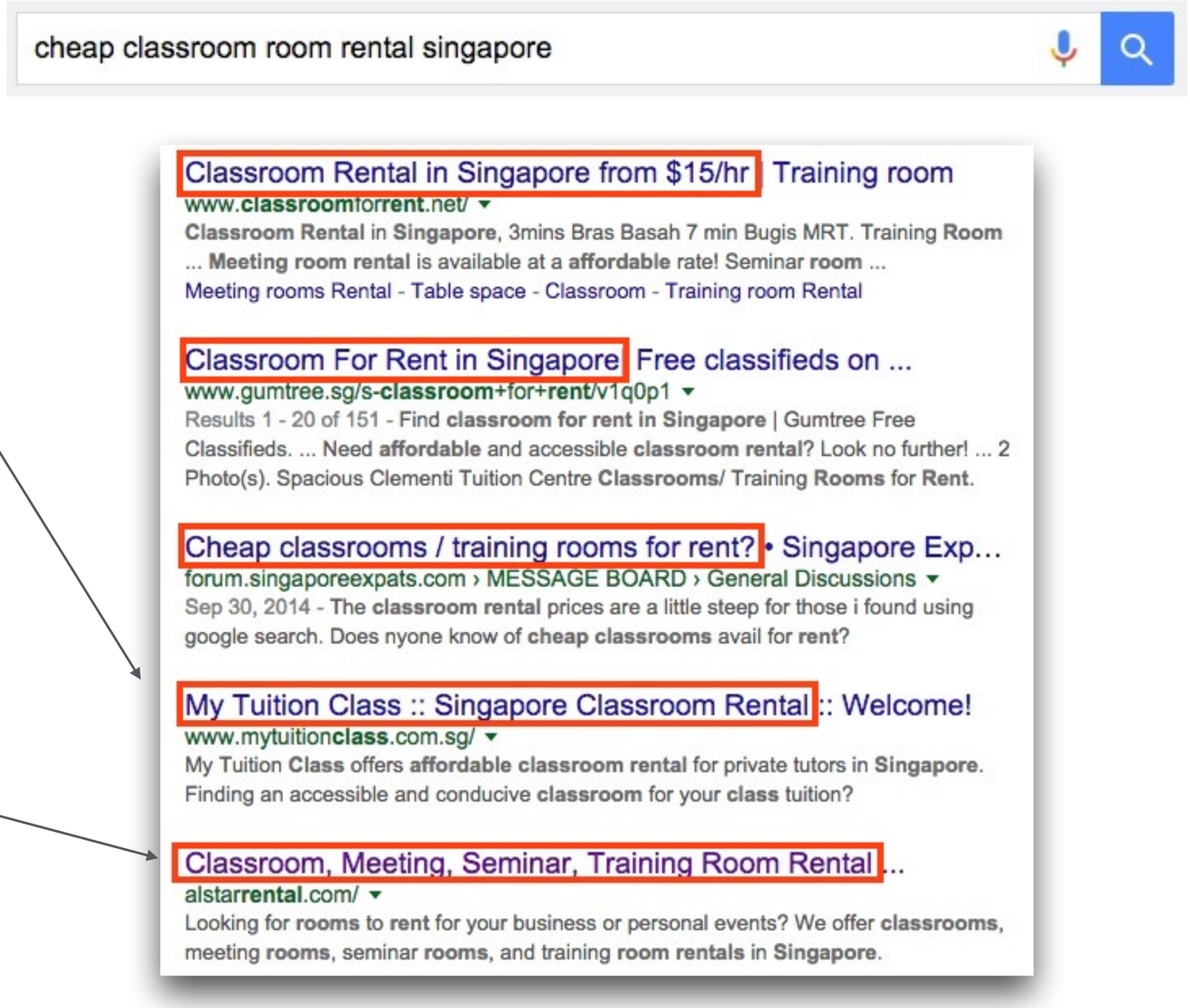
Include your brand name in the title tag

It is good practice to place your brand name in front on the title tag for the homepage and at the back for internal pages of your site.

This increases brand exposure and the likelihood of a user (who has repeated seen the brand's name) clicking on a particular brand's search result.

Optimise for multiple keywords.

Optimising for multiple keywords increases the chances of ranking for more than one keyword. For example, business cards and name cards share similar meaning and can both be included in the title tags if there is sufficient space.



Domain & URL (Best Practices)

- [ ] Keep all sections of your site in one domain or subdomain and avoid nesting folders into deep layers.
- [ ] Include your keywords in your URLs.
- [ ] Keep your domain name and URLs short and easy to understand (< 100 characters) and use lower case letters. Consider removing “stop words” such as *and, or, but, a, etc.*
- [ ] Avoid using uncommon TLDs such as .info, .name, .biz, etc.
- [ ] Avoid rewriting dynamic URLs into static URLs e.g. (www.example.com/index.php?page=icdl-module&id=31)
- [ ] Use hyphens and underscores as word separators but avoid hyphens on domain names.
- [ ] Https secured

Recommended reading:
- https://searchenginewatch.com/sew/how-to/2154469/write-title-tags-search-engine-optimization
- https://support.google.com/webmasters/answer/76329?hl=en

Domain & URL (Best Practices)

Keep all sections of your site in one domain or subdomain and avoid nesting folders into deep layers.

It is recommended to keep your important webpages in sub directories (**e.g. example.com/blog/post/ as opposed to blog.example.com/post/**) as search engines use different ranking metrics for domains and subdomains.

Avoid nesting folders into deep layers e.g. (**www.example.com/folder1/folder2/folder3/example-content**) as search engine spiders may have trouble crawling deeper into your site, Search engines also tend not to crawl deeper into your site if you have a low domain authority.



Domain & URL (Best Practices)

Include your keywords in your URLs.

https://**example.com/classroom-for-rent/**

With that said, exact match domain names (EMD) like **classroom-rental.com** no longer have significant direct impact on rankings after Google turned the knob down on EMDs in the recent years.

However having an EMD can indirectly impact rankings when external sites include a naked hyperlink **(e.g. classroom-rental.com)** to your site, since keywords in the anchor text are considerably an important ranking factor.

Recommended reading:

- https://moz.com/blog/the-exact-match-domain-playbook-a-guide-and-best-practices-for-emds

www.example.com/keyword ✓

www.example.com/?p=123 ✗

Domain & URL (Best Practices)

Keep your domain name and URLs short and easy to understand (< 100 characters) and use lower case letters. Consider removing "stop words" such as and, or, but, a, etc.

This makes it easier for users to remember and type into the browser. Some users may not be exactly sure whether they have gotten the correct spelling of the domain name. Thus they would search for the domain name on Google instead of typing the full address.

Similarly, shorter URLs allow users to easily remember and type the full URL.

Avoid using uncommon TLDs such as .info, .name, .biz, etc.

Uncommon TLDs tend to be used by spammers and don't tend to rank as well as .com domains.

www.example.com/book-event 

www.example.info/book-an-event 

Domain & URL (Best Practices)

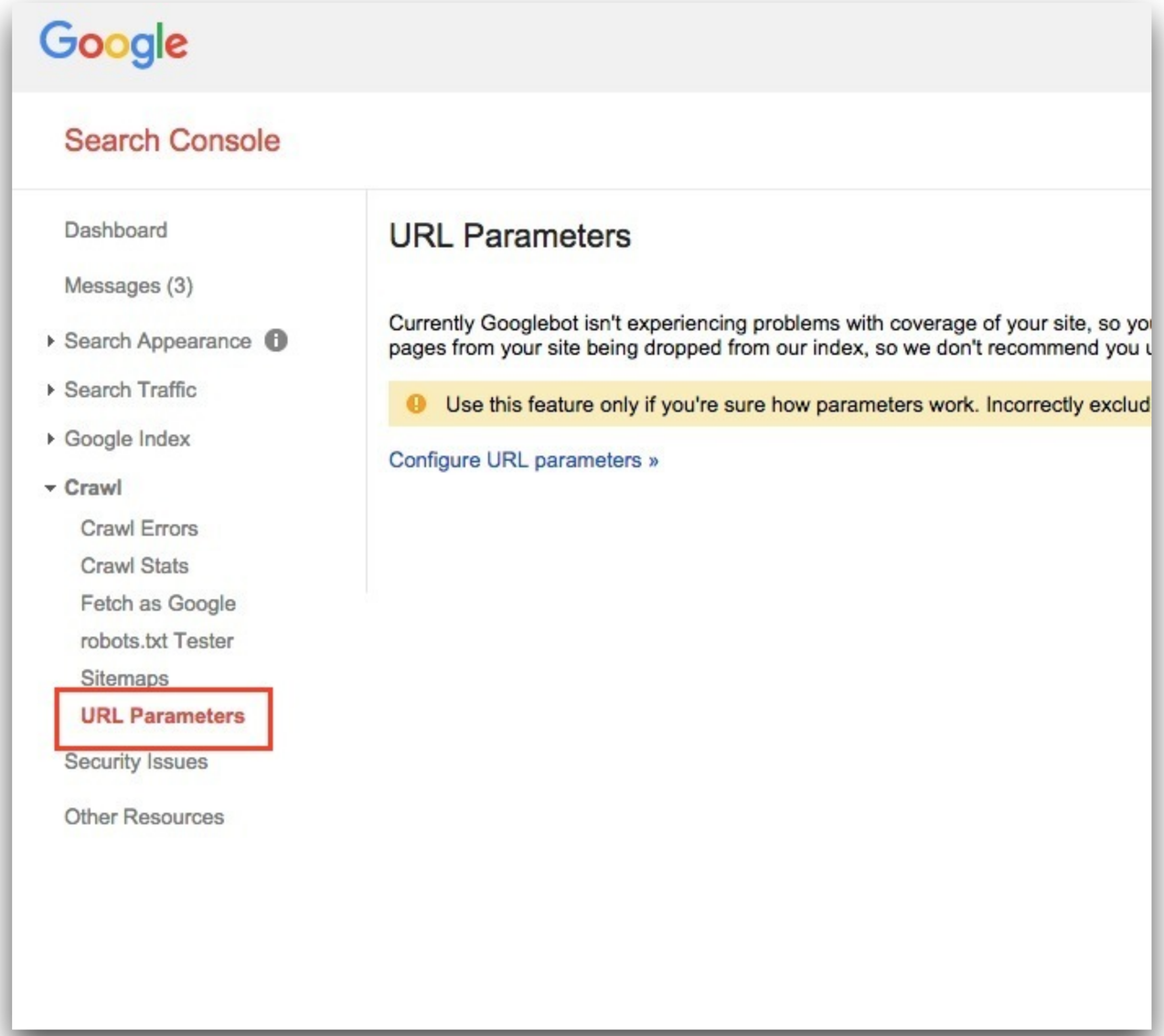
Avoid rewriting dynamic URLs into static URLs e.g. (www.example.com/index.php?page=icdl-module&id=31)

Though it is advisable to use static URLs as much as possible, in cases when you have dynamic content, it is recommended not to remove information (hiding parameters) to make them look static.

To check whether Google has problems crawling your dynamic URLs, you can check for any issues/ alerts in your GWT (Google Webmaster Tools) account.

Recommended reading:

- https://googlewebmastercentral.blogspot.sg/2008/09/dynamic-urls-vs-static-urls.html



Domain & URL (Best Practices)

Use hyphens and underscores as word separators but avoid hyphens on domain names.

Using hyphens and underscores (hyphens preferred) on your URLs is recommended. It helps indicate to search engines the number of keywords used in the URL. E.g. **example.com/rentalounge/** should be written as **example.com/rent-a-lounge/**

On the other hand, domain names should avoid using hyphens as this is common practice among spammy websites. **(e.g. class-room-rental-for-rent.com)**

www.example.com/experts-exchange 

www.example.com/expertsexchange 

HTTPS secured

Google has confirmed the use of HTTPS as a ranking signal. However it is only a very lightweight signal compared to other signals such as high-quality content.

It is still good practice to adopt HTTPS on your websites as Google may decide to strengthen this signal over time.



Meta Description (Best Practices)

- ☐ Keep your meta description between 150 to 160 characters.
- ☐ Include your target keywords in your meta description. (Note: Meta description is not a ranking factor)
- ☐ Make your meta description is unique, outstanding, and persuasive.
- ☐ Ensure it is wrapped around the meta tags **<meta name="description" content="Example meta description content that will often show up in the search results snippets.">** and placed in the **<head></head>** section.
- ☐ Use only alphanumeric characters in your meta description. If wrapped in quotes " ", Google won't display it.
- ☐ Use structured data markup if it is appropriate to the content. (Use a WordPress rich snippets plugin if you are using WordPress. Use schema-creator.org/ if you wish to create your own snippets.)

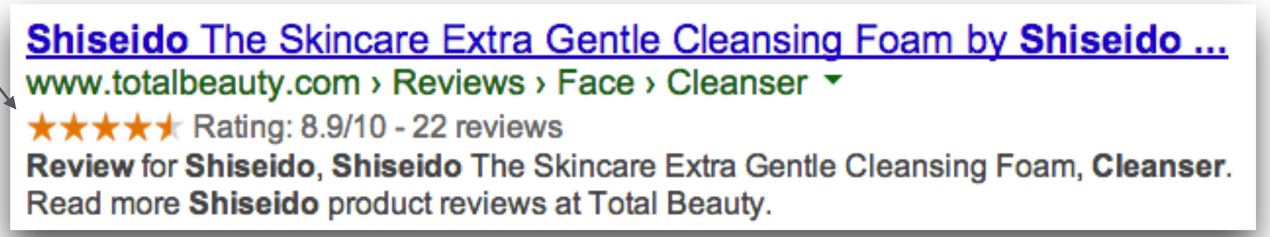


Image Optimisation (Best Practices)

- ☐ Use a descriptive image file name i.e. (car-showroom.jpg instead of DM9902.jpg)
- ☐ Make your alt tags descriptive of the image and include your target keywords when possible (do not stuff keywords). **<img src="http://example.com/uploads/car-showroom.jpg alt="car showroom">**
- ☐ Reduce your image file sizes and use the right image file type (e.g. JPEG is preferred over PNG / GIF).
- ☐ Use unique, high quality, custom graphics/photos where possible to increase chances of people embedding/citing your images.
- ☐ Include your images into your sitemap and submit your sitemap to search engines.

Recommended reading:

- https://developers.google.com/web/fundamentals/performance/optimizing-content-efficiency/image-optimization?hl=en
- http://www.hongkiat.com/blog/ultimate-guide-to-web-optimization-tips-best-practices/
- https://www.shopify.com/blog/7412852-10-must-know-image-optimization-tips
- https://support.google.com/webmasters/answer/114016

Image Optimisation (Best Practices)

Use a descriptive image file name i.e. (car-showroom.jpg instead of DM9902.jpg)

Including your target keywords in your image file names can increase your page's overall relevancy score as search engines are able to pick up the keywords used there within.

Make your alt tags descriptive of the image and include your target keywords when possible (do not stuff keywords)

Search engines factor the image alt tags into their ranking algorithms. Including your target keywords in your image alt tags can help your rankings as well.



```
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avia_animate_when_visible  avia-builder-el-2  el_after_av_table  el_before_av_textblock
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title='Training Room Rental Singapore' alt='Training room' /></a></div></div>
```

Image Optimisation (Best Practices)

Reduce your image file sizes and use the right image file type.

There are a couple of popular graphics formats (e.g. PNG, JPEG, GIF) used on the web. For more information on which file types to use, read this article.

You can reduce your image file sizes by selecting “Save for web” if you’re using a photo editing like Adobe Photoshop. Alternatively you may use a free tool on the web such as jpeg-optimizer to reduce your JPEG file sizes.

Recommended reading:
- http://info.eps.surrey.ac.uk/FAQ/standards.html
- http://jpeg-optimizer.com/

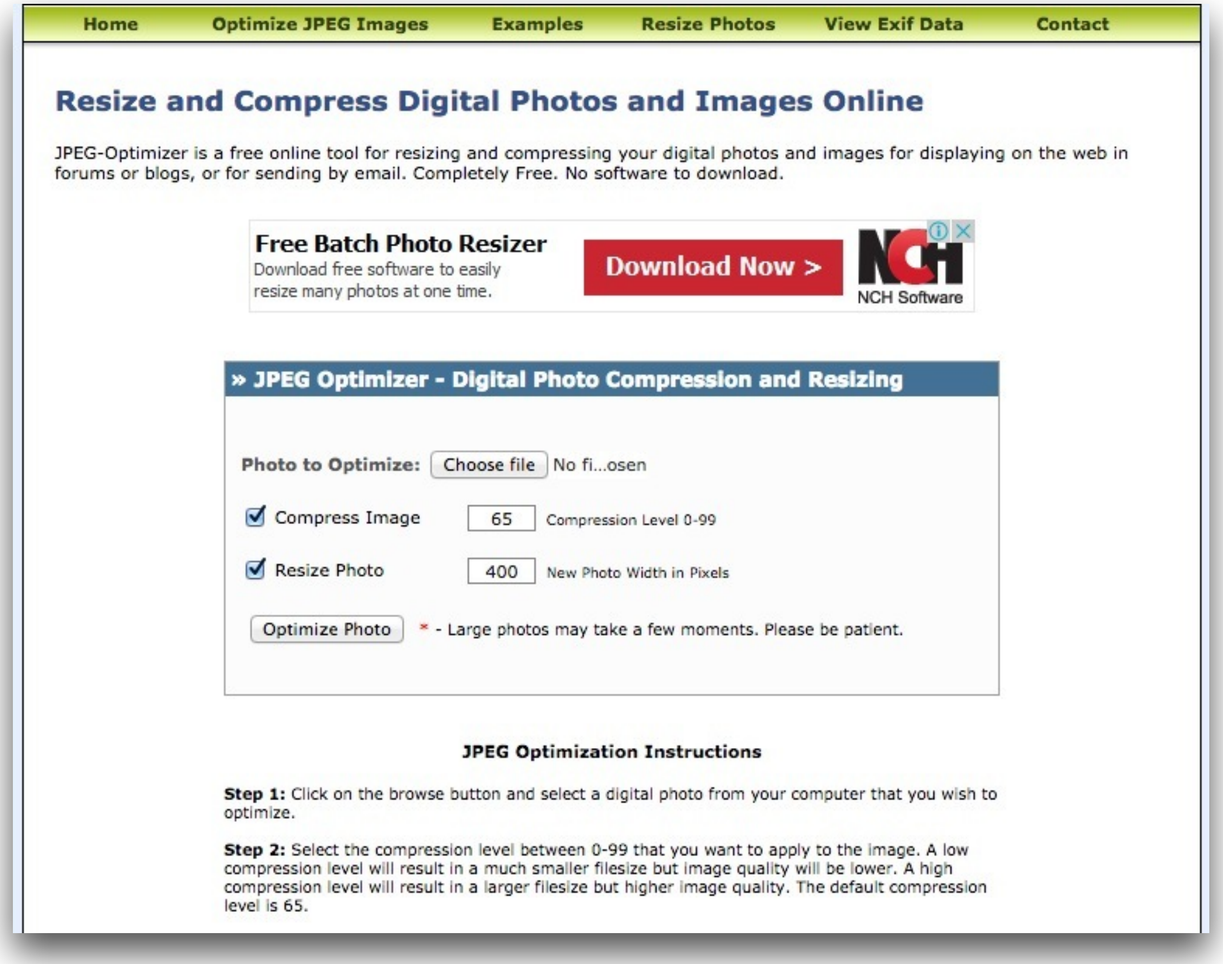


Image Optimisation (Best Practices)

Use unique, high quality, custom graphics/photos where possible to increase chances of people embedding/ citing your images.

Which image are you more likely to trust or link to?





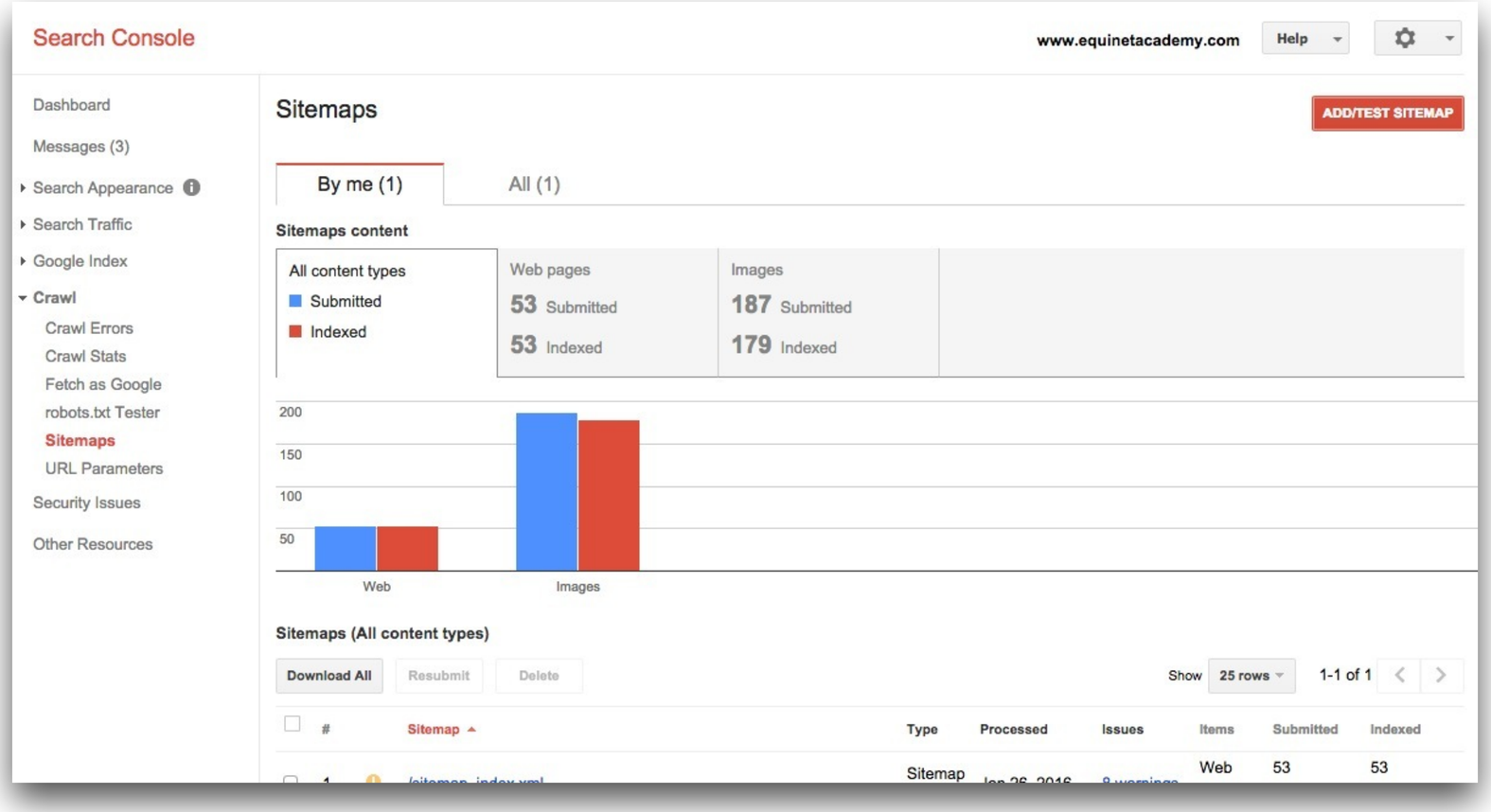
Image Optimisation (Best Practices)

Images sitemaps

Ensure your sitemap has information about your images, otherwise you can also use a separate sitemap for your images.

This helps Google to discover images on your site that they might otherwise not have been able to find.

In your image sitemap, you may indicate which images you want Google to crawl and index.



How to Rank on Youtube and Video Optimisation

- ☐ Conduct keyword research for “Video Keywords” using Keyword Planner and Google Search.
- ☐ Create an awesome video that engages viewers. Good viewer retention sends quality signals to Google.
- ☐ Include Keywords in the video file name, video title, description, and tags.
- ☐ Promote your video on Social Media, Forums, and influencers to increase views. (Views need to be authentic)
- ☐ Video embeds and backlinks pointing to your video send positive ranking signals to Google.

Recommended reading:
- https://moz.com/blog/seo-accessibility-images-video

Content Creation (Best Practices)

- [ ] Ensure your main content (MC) and supplementary content (SC) is relevant to your target keywords and provides the best answer to the searcher intent.
- [ ] Mention your primary and secondary keywords early on in your copy.
- [ ] Primary and secondary keywords should be included in subheadings and distributed evenly throughout your copy.
- [ ] Include keywords that are closely related to your main keywords (also known as Latent Semantic Indexing (LSI) keywords) throughout your copy.
- [ ] Ensure your content is unique and has E-A-T (Expertise, Authoritativeness, Trustworthiness).
- [ ] Write like you're the subject matter expert and worry about keyword optimisation later.
- [ ] Link out to relevant internal pages of your website or relevant external websites where appropriate.

Recommended reading:

- http://static.googleusercontent.com/media/www.google.com/en//insidesearch/howsearchworks/assets/searchqualityevaluatorguidelines.pdf
- On-Page SEO Cheat Sheet
- http://searchengineland.com/rank-position-0-3-simple-steps-featured-snippets-primer-275941

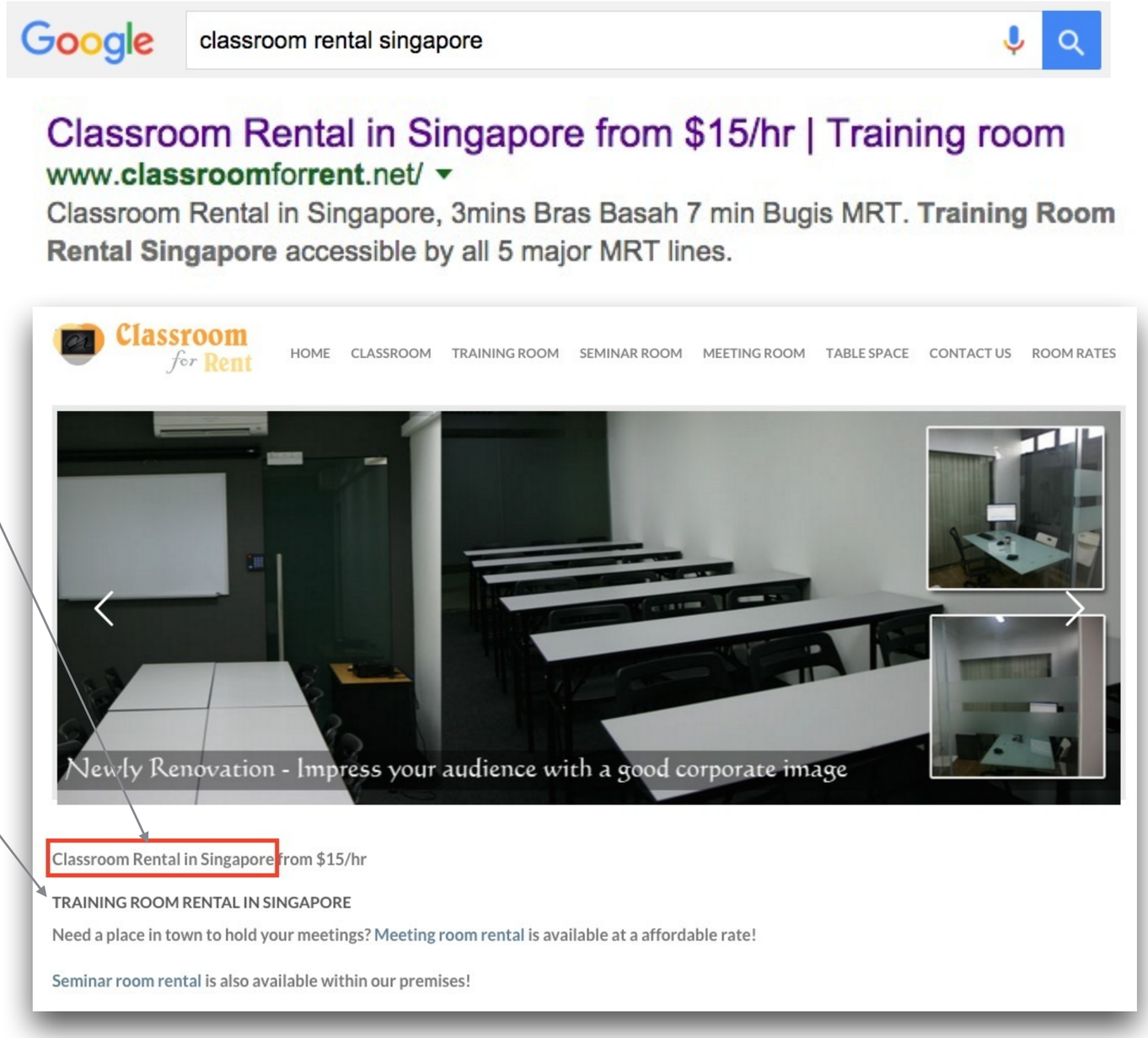
Content (Best Practices)

Mention your primary and secondary keywords early on in your copy.

It is good SEO practice to mention your primary and secondary keywords in the first paragraph of your copy.

Primary and secondary keywords should be included in subheadings.

This helps to minimise "pogo-sticking" (where a visitor bounces back to the search results pages right after clicking on a search result), as visitors expect to see a relevant content after clicking on a search result.



Content (Best Practices)

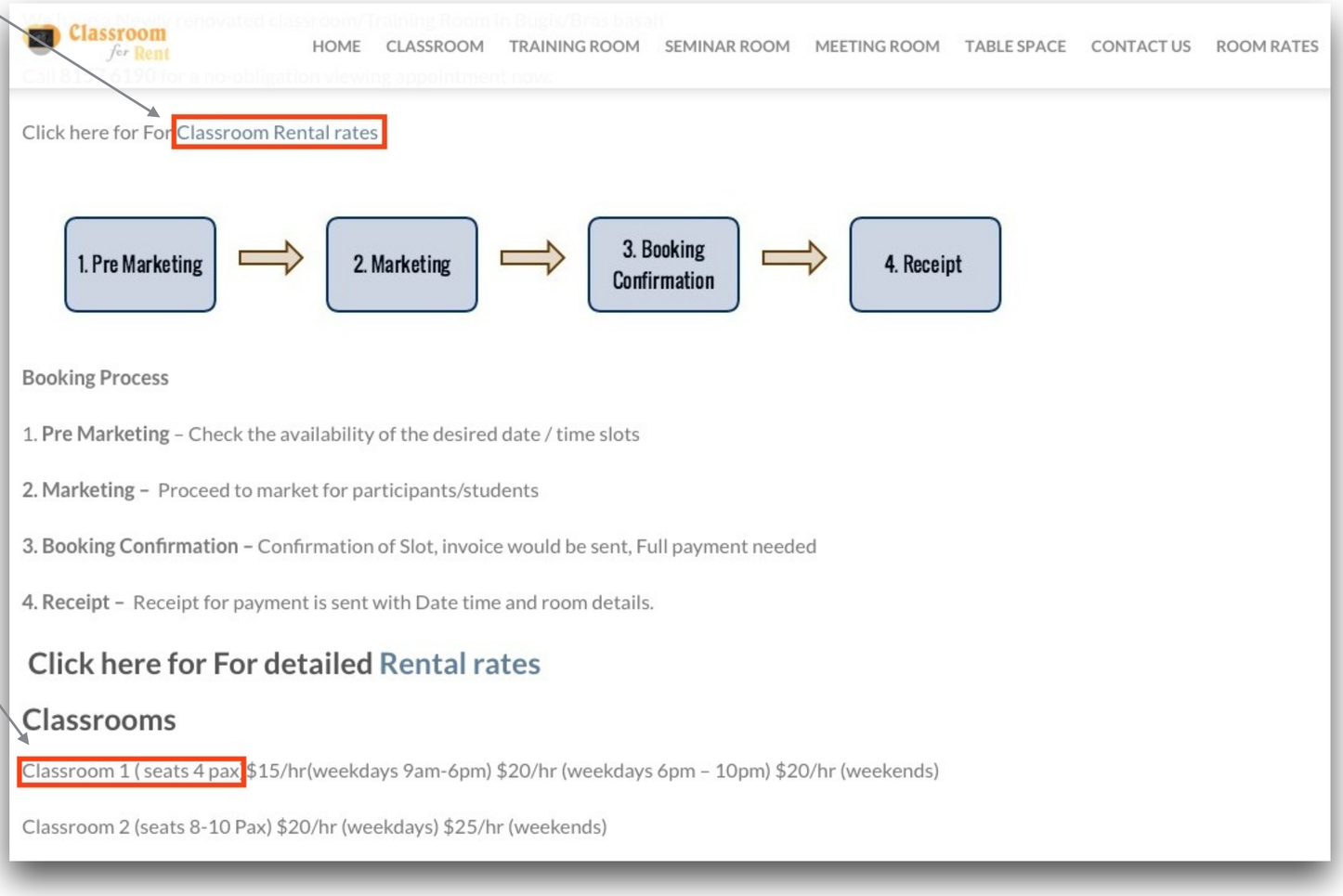
Primary and secondary keywords should be distributed evenly throughout your copy.

This sends signals to search engines that your content is relevant to your target keywords mentioned in your title.

Include keywords that are closely related to your main keywords (also known as Latent Semantic Indexing (LSI) keywords) throughout your copy.

LSI keywords are synonyms of your target keywords and related keywords that are often mentioned or seen together with your target keywords around the web.

Examples of LSI keywords of “classroom rental” are “classroom rental rates”, “seats 4 pax”, “training room rental”.



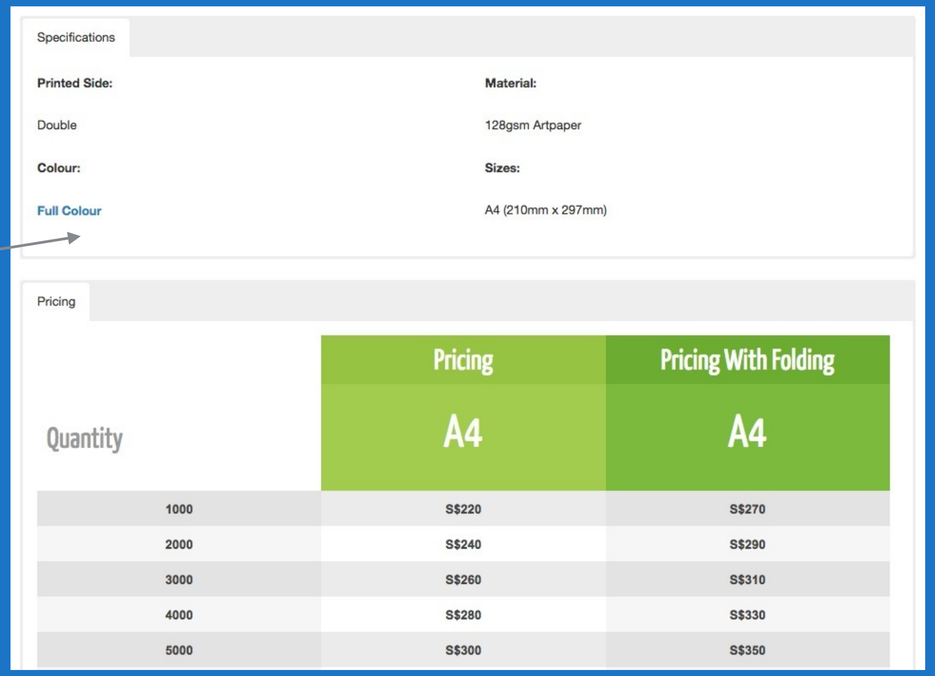
Content (Best Practices)

Ensure main content (MC) and supplementary content (SC) serves its purpose well and is relevant to your target keywords and searcher intent.

Main Content (MC) is any part of the page that directly helps the page achieve its purpose. MC is (or should be!) the reason the page exists. The quality of the MC plays a very large role in the Page Quality rating of a webpage.

Supplementary Content (SC) is also important. SC can help a page better achieve its purpose or it can detract from the overall experience.

Source: [Google Search Quality Rater Guidelines]

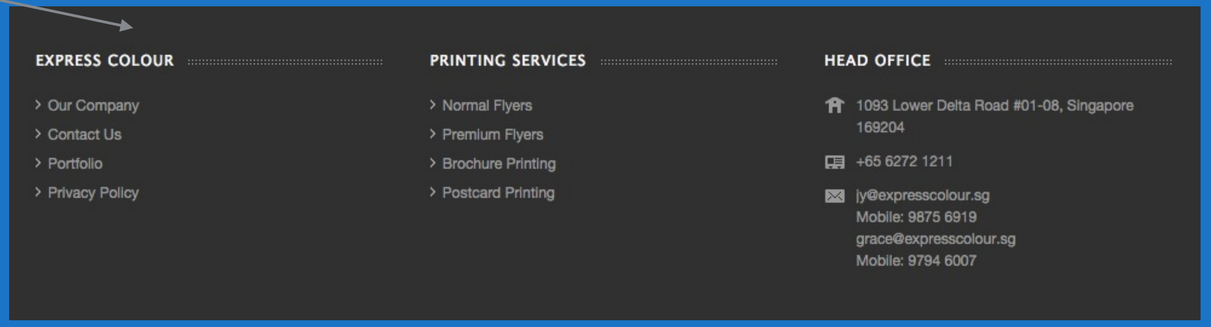


Specifications

Printed Side:	Material:
Double	128gsm Artpaper
Colour:	**Sizes:**
Full Colour	A4 (210mm x 297mm)

Pricing

Quantity	Pricing A4	Pricing With Folding A4
1000	S$220	S$270
2000	S$240	S$290
3000	S$260	S$310
4000	S$280	S$330
5000	S$300	S$350



EXPRESS COLOUR

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PRINTING SERVICES

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- Postcard Printing

HEAD OFFICE

1093 Lower Delta Road #01-08, Singapore 169204

+65 6272 1211

jy@expresscolour.sg
Mobile: 9875 6919
grace@expresscolour.sg
Mobile: 9794 6007

Content (Best Practices)

Ensure your content is unique and has E-A-T (Expertise, Authoritativeness, Trustworthiness) and main content (MC) and supplementary content (SC) serves its purpose well.

In this example, www.xe.com ranks on top for the search term "currency converter". Analysing the search query, we can derive that the user is searching for a tool to convert currency. On www.xe.com, the MC appears prominently and above the page fold.

This tool has also been around for many years and has gained authority and trustworthiness.



Content (Best Practices)

Link out to relevant internal pages of your website or relevant external websites where appropriate.

To improve your pages' relevancy score and help search engines understand the topic of your pages and index them better, link each page back to its category or subcategory pages, related internal pages of your site, and external relevant and reputable sources.



Design & UX (Best Practices)

- [ ] Page layout is designed with the enduser in mind.
- [ ] Main content elements stand out while supplementary content are displayed in a more subtle manner, making page easy to scan through.
- [ ] No excessive placement of ads above the page fold. Ads are not to be disguised as content or be intrusive to users.
- [ ] Use breadcrumbs, submenus, navigational menus to provide users a better user experience when navigating through your site.
- [ ] Text is readable, images and multimedia are high quality.
- [ ] Page renders fast (optimal loading time < 3 seconds).
- [ ] Page is browser and device responsive.

Design & UX (Best Practices)

Page layout is designed with the enduser in mind.

Google knows when users click on a search result and immediately bounces back to the search results pages a.k.a. pogo sticking, and not fixing this issue can affect your rankings.

Always put yourself in the position of the enduser, then design your pages.

Recommended reading:

- https://studio.uxpin.com/blog/4-things-youll-never-hear-from-successful-ux-designers/



Main content elements stand out while supplementary content are displayed in a more subtle manner, making page easy to scan through.

The main content should be displayed prominently on the page's real estate. For tabbed content for example, display the main content in the display-by-default tab.

No excessive placement of ads above the page fold. Ads are not to be disguised as content or be intrusive to users.

Don't use ads that pop/slide out and block the page's content when the user's mouse hovers over it, or text ads that trick the user into thinking it is part of the page's written content.

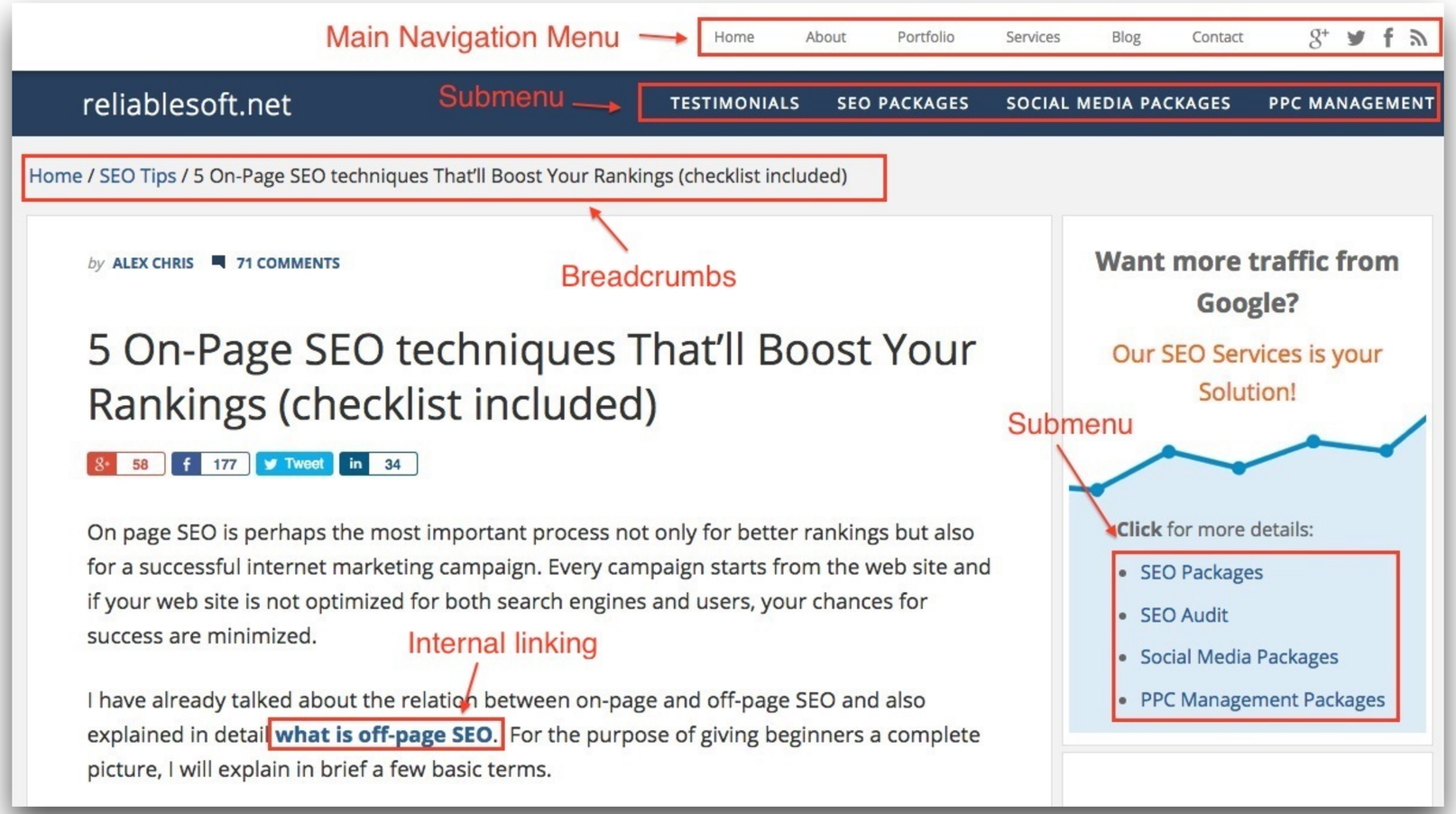


Use breadcrumbs, submenus, navigational menus to provide users a better user experience when navigating through your site.

Though it is not necessary to include all of the above site navigational elements, it is good practice to include at least one or two of them.

Text is readable, images and multimedia are high quality.

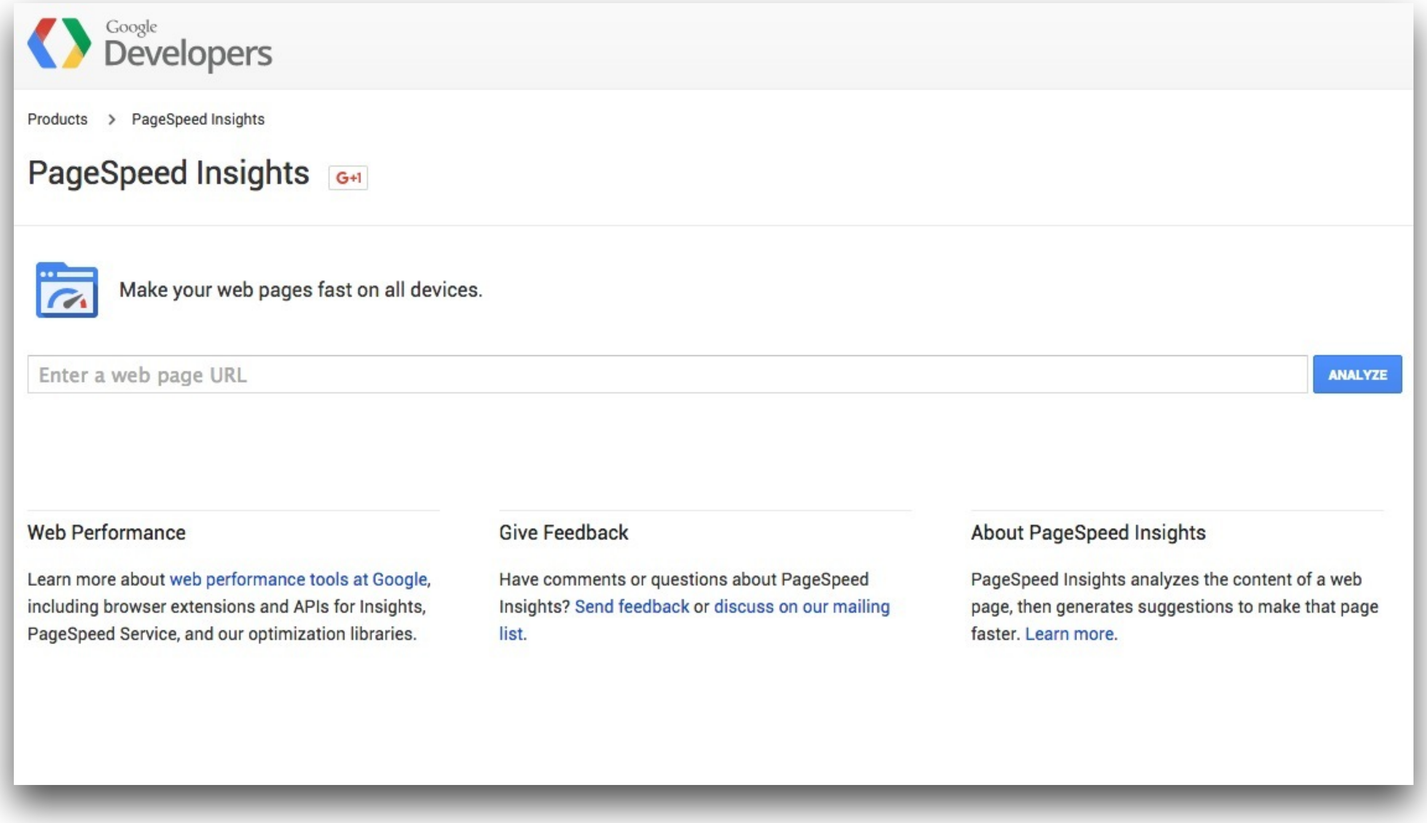
Font-family, text colour, and font size should be clear and easy to scan through. Images and multimedia such as videos should be of high quality and optimised for speed.



Page renders fast (optimal loading time < 4 seconds).

Page loads from server and renders fast with an optimal server response time of < 0.5 seconds and a completely loaded page of < seconds.

You may check for any issues hindering your page speed with a free tool provided by Google - Pagespeed Insights.



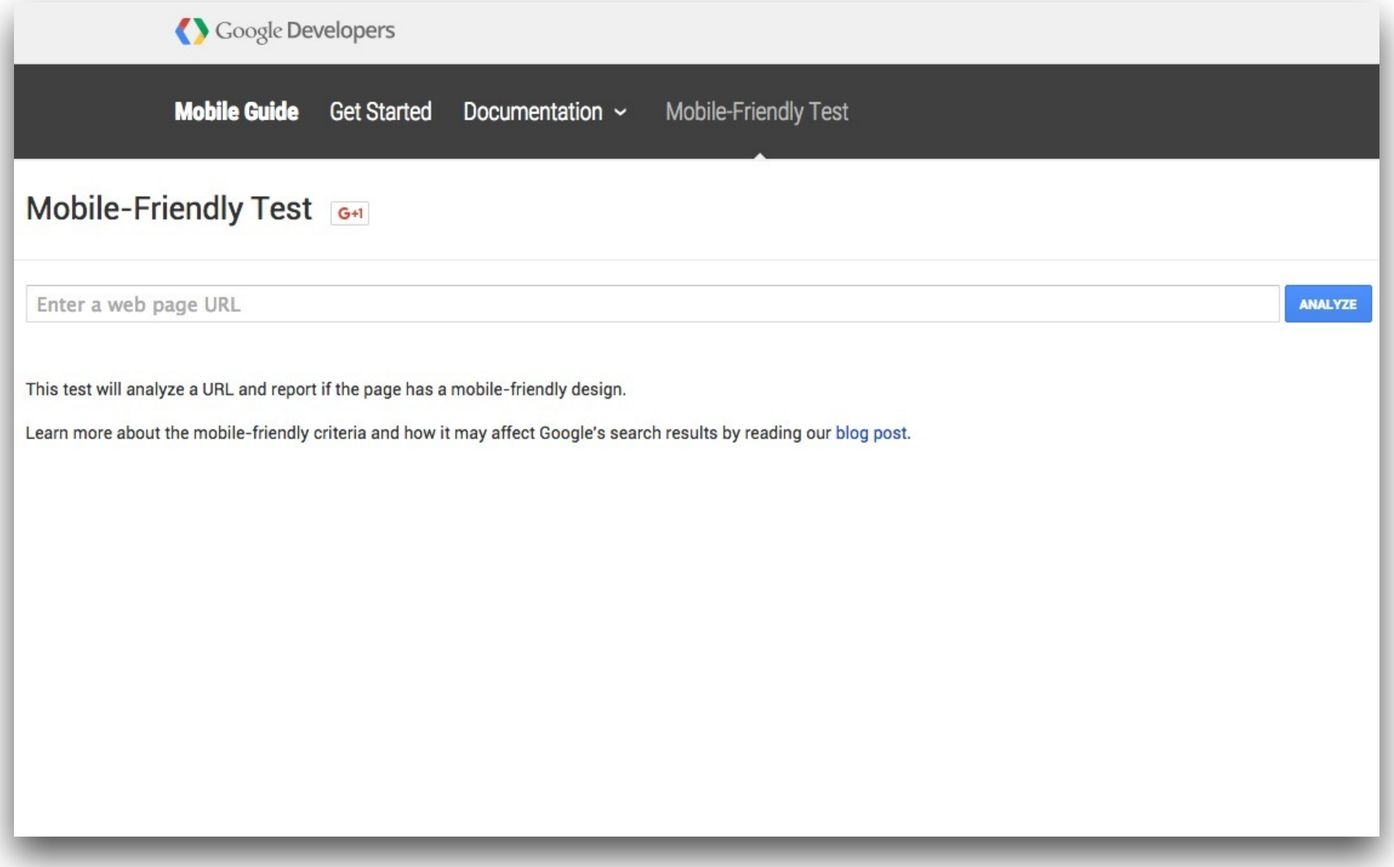
Recommended reading:
- http://www.dwuser.com/education/content/10-steps-to-a-faster-wordpress/

Page is browser and device responsive.

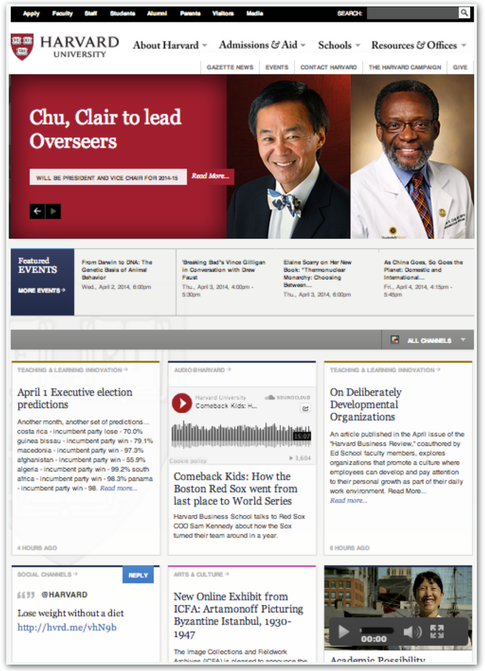
Following the Google Mobile Friendly Update a.k.a. Mobilegeddon since April 2015, pages that aren't mobile friendly may not rank as well on mobile searches, though this issue does not affect desktop searches.

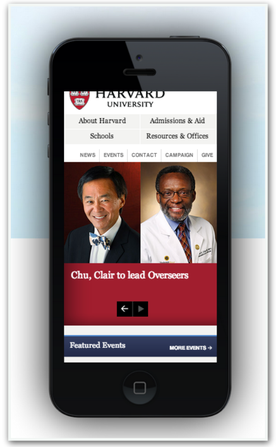
Note: This only affects pages on an individual basis. Meaning that if a site has certain pages that aren't mobile friendly, it will not affect the overall rankings of mobile friendly pages.

To test whether your page is mobile friendly, you can use Google's Mobile-Friendly Testing Tool.

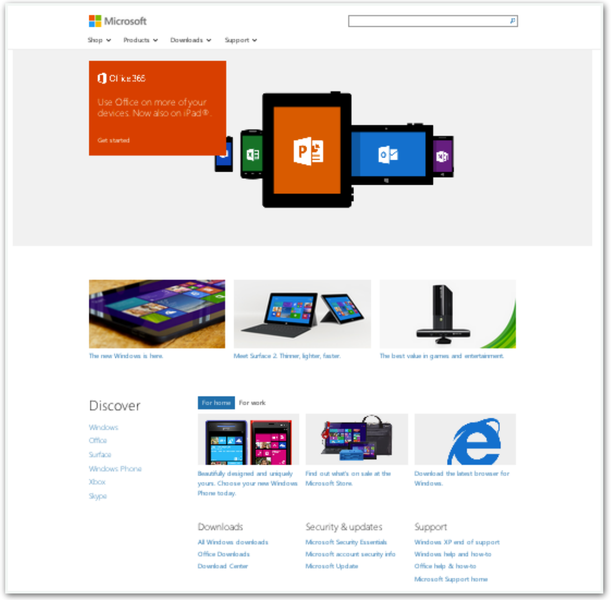


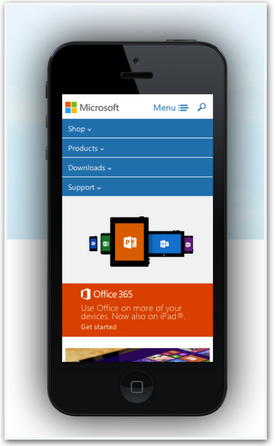
Responsive Design





Dynamic Serving

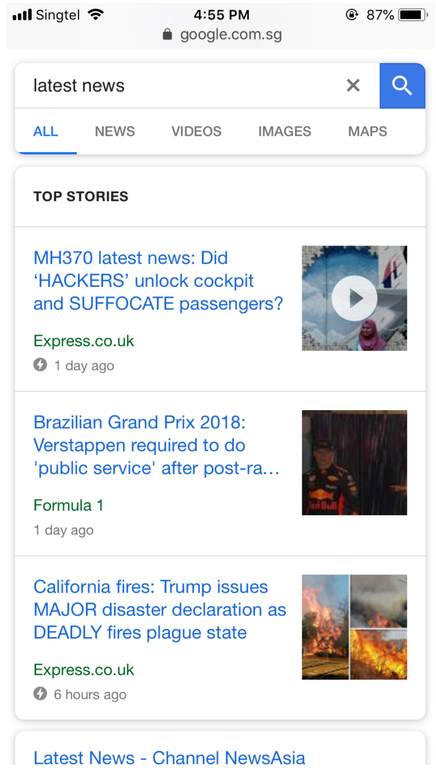


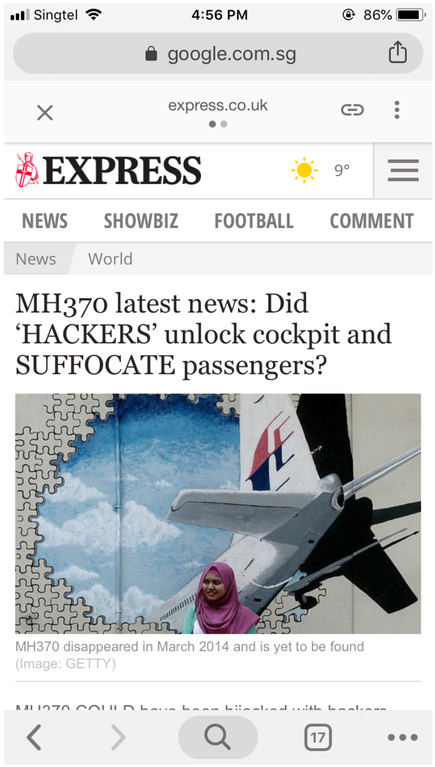


Recommended reading:

- https://developers.google.com/webmasters/mobile-sites/mobile-seo/responsive-design
- https://developers.google.com/webmasters/mobile-sites/mobile-seo/dynamic-serving

AMP - Accelerated Mobile Pages





Recommended reading:
- https://www.ampproject.org/

—— End of Sample Courseware Preview ——

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and learn how to rank your website on page #1 of Google